Evangelizing our World:

Insights from Global Inquiry

by

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Foreword

The 1974 Lausanne Congress was an amazing experience. A new wind was blowing for World Evangelization as we came together to discuss how we could bring the Gospel to ALL people. This 1974 event gave inspiration to groups around the world and, in subsequent years, we saw the results of this as Lausanne groups and committees were formed in different countries, senior associates ministered around the world, challenging publications were published, and there was a spirit of partnership and cooperation.

The 1974 congress was followed by a significant strategy consultation in 1980 in Pattaya, Thailand, and in 1989 by the second Lausanne Congress in Manila, Philippines. From that time, we saw the extensive activities of the AD2000 movement. It is in that same spirit the 2004 Lausanne Forum takes place to consult on significant global changes, both external to the task of world evangelization as well as changes within the churches.

The Global Inquiry so excellently and tirelessly managed by Dr. Luis Bush has had as its major aim to consult the global fellowship of Christians, and sense God's calling of the global church in its mission of world evangelization at the beginning of the twenty-first century.

A total of almost 7000 leaders have been involved in the process with a major emphasis on countries that are emerging as key players in global evangelization. As we look at the situation in the world, it is quite clear that the centers of inspiration and dynamism for world evangelization have moved from the western countries to countries in other parts of the world.

This report is primarily based on data gathered during the events conducted by Luis Bush in countries around the world. The observations are put into perspective from other sources, and recommendations prepared for use by Issue Groups and others concerned for world evangelization.

Viggo Sogaard, PhD Senior Professor of Communication, Fuller School of Intercultural Studies

Chapter 1

Consulting the World

A few years ago, Dr. Richard Mouw, President of Fuller Theological Seminary, wrote an intriguing little book titled, "Consulting the Faithful".[1] In the book, Dr. Mouw challenged Christian intellectuals to learn from popular religion, that is listening to those who are sitting in the pews each week, so that the message may be relevant and understood.

The challenge to "listen to the faithful" could be given to all workers in church and mission. Recently I was on an evaluation trip to an African country, and as I travelled with the leader of the organization, he expressed his delight in what he was learning. "We are used to tell people what to do, not listening to them or ask if our message is understood," he commented. Some years ago, in an Asian country, a local theological seminary had tried again and again to get local, rural pastors interested in a training program. When the leadership of the seminary was challenged to visit rural pastors and listen to them, everything changed. For one, they had a tremendous burden for these pastors, as they understood their situation and needs, but they also prepared a training program that would fit *their* need, and not just the need of the seminary.

Our task is not complete by just preaching. Only when we are willing to listen to people and to their needs are, we ready and qualified to come with some answers. It is my hope that those involved in evangelism will increasingly listen to people, so that they may be willing to listen to us.

Men of Issachar

Communication is at the core of mission. But communication is an interactive process where the listener plays a significant role in the communication process. It is not what we said, that is most important, but what people heard us saying. In this task, we can learn from God. We have a communicating God who asks us to be communicators of Good News.

[1] Richard Mouw, Consulting the Faithful, Wm. B. Eerdmans Publishing Company, 1994.

According to Dr. Kraft, the accurate translation of Mark 16:15 would be, "Go into everyone's world to communicate what they will perceive as Good News". Unfortunately, we have usually interpreted *Good News* from a sender-oriented perspective, but it takes on new and exciting dimensions when we learn to understand that *Good News* must be seen from a receptor-oriented position. In communication language, following the great Canadian communication philosopher Marshall McLuhan, media are the extensions of human beings.[2] In John 20:21 we read that Jesus commissioned the disciples to continue to extend his mission, "As the Father has sent me, so I send you." Jesus had "extended" the Father in such a complete communication that he was an exact representation of the Father, and people had seen and heard the Father as if He was there. Jesus created true peace and harmonious relationships, making sense of it all for the common man and woman.

I was recently with some friends in Bangkok who are ministering in the slums among people living on the sharp edge between life and death. Their approach is truly incarnational, living among the people, ministering through their own culture through dance, music, and drama, and in that process they bring a holistic message of hope in Jesus Christ. They experience blessings as people receive God's Word, and they have proved that people are open to the Gospel when it is presented in such a way that the listeners perceive it as good news.

The global BBC News Service has a commercial for its own service that says, *"BBC World. Making sense of it all."* Our task is to help people *make sense of it all* in multiple contexts around the world so that the Gospel does indeed become GOOD news. The Lausanne Movement

[2] Marshall McLuhan, Understanding Media: The Extensions of Man, Bantam Books, NY, 1964.

we need to inspire and to prepare people for effective communication in a rapidly changing world. Advanced education tends to dwell on the past, but the *future* must be part of *our* present.

To make sense presupposes that we know our audience, we know their needs, and we know what make them laugh or cry. As we attempt to understand our present world and the trends that we see on the horizon, we need to prepare our- selves for such a situation. And there are some clear global trends that will increasingly challenge us and our evangelistic efforts.

Global trends are those that are creating the reality in which we need to function in the future, and for which we need to pre- pare today. Many others have written about global trends, and I have been fascinated by people who have been able to interpret trends for us, and lifted the curtain so that we are able to see practical implications for the Church.

In 1 Chron.12:32 we find David in need of help, so the tribes of Israel sent him thousands of soldiers, but from the tribe of Issachar, they sent 200 leaders "who understood the times and knew what Israel should do." Similarly, today, we need those who can interpret global trends so that we can prepare strategies and train people who will minister effectively five or ten years from now. I will highlight a few areas or trends that I find are of crucial importance to missiological communication.

1. A Non-Reading World

There are two types of people here: those who are non-literate and cannot read, and those who can read, but chooses not to. Statistics are often difficult, as so much depend on definitions, but the fact is that there are more and more people who cannot read, and an increasing number choose not to read.

Official statistics indicate that around 1.3 billion people are not able to read, and if the functionally non-literates are added, the number is very large. Furthermore, in countries that boast up to 100% literacy, a third or more of the population may not read anything significantly. My estimate is that less than half the world's people are readers, and the number could be much higher. Yet, al- most everything in church communication is based on literacy. Walter Ong has challenged our total emphasis on literacy, pointing out that literacy produces patterns of thought which are only understandable when the mind has internalized the technology of writing.[3]

My own country of Denmark is a country with 9 years of compulsory education and officially 100% literate, but government statistics coming out last April indicated that every second person has problems with reading. Every third per- son does not read

anything significantly. The fact is that less and less people are reading, and few are interested in learning to read. In some countries of Africa, we estimate that only 10-15% can be reached through printed texts. India has close to half a billion people who are officially non-literate. And in our western countries, young people are becoming non-readers.

An interesting survey has been conducted by the Brazilian Book Association regarding book ownership in Brazil.[4] It states that 61% of those adults in Brazil who know how to read and write have little or no contact with books. 6.5 million people in the low-income section of the population cannot afford to buy one, and 73% of books are concentrated in the hands of only 16% of the population. These figures clearly show that the challenge is not just one of teaching people to read and write, but it is also making reading material available and used.

This global change has, of course, great influence on Bible reading: few people read the Bible, and few people pay attention to Bible reading in church. Few people understand the Bible reading in church. Still, almost everything we do in church and mission is based on a linear print orientation. Even follow up material to radio programs is in print, study material is in print, and the way we teach new pastors to prepare sermons is based on a linear model which does not make sense to the non-reading population. The sad thing is that most pastors do not seem to take this situation seriously.

[3] Walter J Ong, Orality & Literacy, The Technologizing of the Word, Routledge, London, 1982.

[4] Sociedade Biblica do Brasil, "A Biblia no Brasil", No. 204, Julho a Setembro de 2004.

Recently I asked a pastor, who had a congregation where only half of the members could read, what he did for the non-readers. "I just preach to them," was his answer. For the literate he conducted Bible studies, because they could follow the material, he had available.

So, how do we get a handle on this challenge? First, we must motivate church and mission leaders by making them aware of the situation and its implications for the future. We also need to prepare material that is based on oral communication principles. I have for 17 years served as a consultant to the United Bible Societies, struggling with the issue of communicating the Scriptures. The mandate of the UBS has intrigued me as the Word of God is to be made available to ALL people in a language they can understand, in a medium that is appropriate, and at a price they can afford.[5] I believe that this framework is close to the biblical communication challenge, and could be an appropriate context for missiological education and strategy in year 2004,… and 2005, 2006 and so on.

Jesus was a master communicator for oral people. He told stories which we call parables. These stories were relevant to the people, and they had such a significant content that they inspire us today.

It is also interesting to remember the situation in New Testament times when the church spread rapidly throughout Palestine, Asia Minor, and on to Europe. They did not have a written New Testament, and the Old Testament was not readily available. This is inconceivable today, but we do have a few people who have understood the times and prepared approaches that fit. For example, the Bible Society of Egypt sells around a million audio cassettes a year, and they sell more videos than printed Bibles.

For theological seminaries, where we are training missiological communicators, the challenge is not only to teach students how to write papers, but how to present that same material in media that are relevant to where people are today and will be in the future. For example, how do we teach them to make sense of it all for the non-literate fishermen on the coast of Ghana if we only teach them to write papers? Or, how to reach teenagers in Canada who watch videos but do not read books? And this leads to the next point which is the basic cause of it all.

[5] Viggo Sogaard, Communicating Scriptures, United Bible Societies, Reading, England, 2002.

2. Non-linear Thinking World

As we move from the familiar, linear world into a world with non-linear thinking, almost everything we do in church and mission is challenged. The primary difference is between print orientation and visual orientation. Print works on linear cognitive input, that is information, while video works on the affective dimensions, feelings and impact.

Spoken language is characteristically different from written language. Rhythm, intonations, loudness, voice quality, pauses, and pace are some of the features of spoken language that are left out in writing. George Bernard Shaw once said, "There are fifty ways of saying Yes, and five hundred of saying No, but only one way of writing them down."

One project that is working on this issue is the "Radio Bible". It consists of 365 fifteen-minute programs that can be on air from radio stations across the world and in local languages. The program format will be suited for radio broadcasting. A central core will consist of a Scripture passage, presented in a variety of ways, but the program will also have engagement material so that listeners can interact with the text, understand it, and apply it to their daily lives. Radio programs need to be self-contained so that communication takes place while the program is on the air.

Or we can put the text to music. Music appeals to our feelings and emotions, and with music we seek to influence the feelings of others. An interesting example of a good audio approach was the pro- duction of an Easter cassette in Bangladesh. Fourteen passages of Scripture were chosen, providing a full Easter story. The texts were then given to five composers who put the text to Bengali music. The result was an Easter story presented in an appropriate medium for non-reading people. They sing the story. The real challenge is video, and here our attention is primarily on the so-called post-literate, or post-modern young people who are brought up on music television. It may be that most of us do not watch MTV, but for many teenagers, MTV forms the wallpaper in their lives. There is an interesting article by David Hopkins with the challenging title of, *Everything I ever needed to know about ministry I learned from …MTV*[6].

In the article he claims that *Image is not everything, it's the only thing.* Our value systems have shifted from pragmatics to aesthetics. What is good is not always what works or what is true, but rather what is beautiful and attractive. When teenagers turn on MTV, the sounds, clothes, colors, and setting instantly draw them in. The images create a kind of comforting sanctuary. It has something to do with intimate experiences, not sit- ting in rows but in circles, giving a sense of communal experience. In a recent survey among

teenagers in Denmark, the primary reason for not attending church was that they felt the worship service was boring.[7]

Another issue raised by the article relates to identity. We are no more in a world with static identities, but identity sought after by the MTV generation must be meaningful, transitional, and communal. It is not just a matter of identification with an audience, but it is providing identity to the audience. If the identity is not found in family or church, teenagers will find that identity from the glowing screen. But the identity they seek must be meaningful, so that the result will be healing from depression or loneliness. When I studied television production, we talked about four-second shots. MTV has mastered the split-second shot as images move over the screen, creating an emotional impact.

As we struggle with these issues, we need to ask ourselves how we can communicate in such a context. How do we reach the MTV generation with a message of wholeness, meaning, and fellow- ship? We are not in the entertainment industry, trying to amuse ourselves, but in the real world to communicate what in their minds will sound as *good news.*

When we deal with images and visual media, there is a real concern for the total image. The late British broadcaster and writer, Malcolm Muggeridge, con- tended that it is next to impossible to communicate truth through television. He saw an ever-widening chasm be- tween the fantasy the media induce us to live, and the reality of our existence as made in the image of God. He concluded that the very make-up of television makes it impossible to communicate reality, because television functions in a world of fantasy, or fiction.[8]

Even though we may disagree with Muggeridge on several points, we do face the challenge of handling the transfer from a traditional written medium to an image-based medium.

[6] David Hopkins, Everything I ever needed to know about ministry I learned from MTV. Next Wave Magazine, June 1999.
[7] Bo Lundgaard, "The Answers by 1119 Teenagers" in Teenagers & Tro II, Youth Resources, Copenhagen, 2000.
[8] Malcolm Muggeridge, Christ and the Media, p. 30. Hodder and Stoughton, London, 1977.

When translating a text, a one-to-one correspondence between a source text and a new text is never a true reality. In other words, a new translation will always have certain variations from the original. The functional equivalence view of translation recognizes that words function within a network of meaning effects in both the source and target languages.

Faithfulness to the text does not rely on mere one-to-one correspondence, but rather depends upon a functional equivalence regarding how words operate in each respective language. So, when we consider translating or adapting a written text into audio or video, we cannot just look at the linguistic relationships, but we also need to see correspondence be- tween sound and visual elements. Such elements may be implied in the source text, but they now need to be made explicit in a video product. The message is now a combination of the actual written text, as well as sounds, voices, music, genre, talent, setting, costumes, lighting, graphics, symbols, etc. The communication effect depends on all these inputs, and they influence the translation of the message and the creation of meaning in the minds of the viewer. And that message must be relevant, reliable, and reasonable.

3. A Non-Passive World

Audiences have never been passive. To achieve communication effects, the listener must play an active part in the process. This is often done sub- consciously, and in Christian ministry we have usually taken it for granted. But we are today challenged by new kinds of audiences that are very active in challenging, confronting, and responding. New issues are raised, and many such issues are pressing us today and will do so increasingly in the future. As the Gospel of life is a message of reconciliation, we will increasingly be called upon to be peacemakers among people suffering from social, ethnic, and racial conflicts.

We have an increasingly active **fundamentalist world.** Christians are faced with radical religious groups, Islamic groups, but also Hindu extremists. Persecution of Christians is a reality in many countries. But we also need to realize that people in some countries view the Christian fundamentalist movements with equal concern and distrust. Christians have been drawn into a defensive position and we need to learn how to relate. In many countries which are not used to pluralistic contexts, we find fear and opposition among some Christian groups. There is a tendency to

isolate and confront, rather than reconciliation and loving service. We need to learn, that there is to be respect for people of other Faiths as fellow human beings who share with Christians common human concerns.[9]

Some years ago, Marvin Mayers proposed a verbal communication model, based on the *Prior Question of Trust.*[10] The prior question of trust asks, Is what I am saying or doing building or undermining trust? Only when a bridge of trust has been created can we expect a message to be communicated. Such a respect will be reciprocated, creating a basis for dialogue, but it will also challenge us to train people who so that they are able to present the Christian Faith in a clear, friendly, transparent, and ap- pealing way. A lack of trust will seriously affect evangelism results.

We also need to realize that the world in which we are called to communicate the love of Jesus is a **poverty-stricken world.** And we find in many places that the poor are not passive. The primary concern of Jesus was to bring *good news* to the poor, as we see from the start of his ministry in the synagogue in Nazareth, Lk. 4:18. His first words were, *"The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, because he has chosen me to bring good news to the poor."* All through his ministry, we find Jesus showing special respect and concern for the poor and the outcast. Yet, when we look at material produced for evangelism today, it is very difficult to find any that are produced for the poor and relevant to their need.

How do we help the poor "make sense of it all"? How do we decide to select news stories that are of importance to those who are humiliated and forced to live their lives in the refugee camps on the West Bank? Or those suffering from hunger in Southern Sudan? What would constitute *good news* in their world? By asking such questions I believe we are indeed focusing on the issues that seemed to be most central to the thinking of Jesus.

Another non-passive group are the young people in westernized cities and churches. We are also finding that the younger generations are non-passive, as they are turned off by so-called one-way communication and top-down leadership in churches. The **Post-Modern World** is an active world, and as such a world that is creating stress among Christian leaders. They are challenged by young people who are requesting dialog rather than one-way preaching. What communicates to them is when they see principles

[9] Viggo Sogaard, Communicating Scriptures, p. 13/1.United Bible Societies, Reading, England, 2002.
[10] Marvin K. Mayers, Christianity Confronts Culture, Zondervan Publishing House, 1974.

applied in real life. They are challenging authority that is based on position and not on personal achievements. Statements of faith are of little interest unless seen in practice.

A similar result of post-modernism is seen in mission agencies. There are still many agencies that have their basis in western countries, and "mission field" offices are extension centers of the headquarters. But the national leaders are not passive anymore. They have in their mission understanding and evangelism results moved way ahead of their "parents", and they are asking for independence and partnership. The organizations that have been able to move through such a transition successfully are blessed by having partners and col- leagues that greatly expand their own visions, but the agencies are also challenged to provide support in new and creative ways.

Missiological Communication

In Christian ministry we have tended to measure our effectiveness by the level of our own activities, but the issue is not the amount of activity, but the obtained results. It is not a question of how many tracts are distributed or how many hours we are on the air, or even how many books we have written, but it is a matter of what the results are of what we do. It may be impressive to report millions of Bibles sold, but a more important statistic would be to know how many read the Bible and apply the message to their daily lives. It has been my experience that much of what we call evangelism often has few evangelistic effects, but at the same time there are many projects that do not claim to be evangelistic, but they have significant evangelistic effects.

For a major research project with World Vision International, we attempted to measure spiritual effects of development programs, and in the process, we learned significant things about mission and communication. For example, the one project that seemingly had greatest impact on Church growth was a road building project in a certain African country, all paid for by government money. As we studied the situation and tried to discover the reasons, we found a project that was relating to the felt needs of people who had been suffering from civil war, but we also found simple people who had experienced new life in Christ and they just witnessed to that new life.

In a holistic project, we are talking about economic improvement, social welfare and wholeness, and the experience of spiritual reality. In other words, we are looking for better finances, healthier families with improved social life, as well as people praising and thanking God. In one project, a water irrigation project, we found that the financial income had in- creased almost ten-times. But as we looked closer, the man still gave

the same amount to his wife and then used the rest on alcohol. Was it successful? for the spirit of the river, which had given them water. Spiritually, the project was also a total failure. The question was, then, what could be done to make such a project truly holistic with economic, social, and spiritual effects?

We are living in a changing world, a world where "Truth is stranger than it used to be."[11] How do we integrate these communication challenges in our evangelism efforts? We need to learn multiple processing skills, and in societies with broken homes and domestic violence, abused children and youth with lost hopes, how do we apply the Scriptures so that we provide comfort, give hope and freedom, and demonstrate the presence of God in the midst of suffering. And in a world in which our environment is threatened, how do we go out in front and work for stewardship of God-given resources instead of ruining our world with pollution and destruction, all be- cause of financial benefits for the rich nations?

The influence of media is also a global concern, and in many ways the media reflect the challenges which our global world is facing. It has been called a Global Village, but it is not a global village, as some would like us to think. In a village, all have equal access to receive and to send news. Due to modern technology, the villages of the world have now become targets of communication by those with power and can afford the access. There is no equal access to broadcasting news, and the interests of poor people of the world are of little interest to the world media. They select news and stories that are of interest to the rich. One of my greatest encouragements is when I meet in the jungle and mountains on the Thai-Burma border with leaders of ethnic groups who are brutally persecuted by the Burmese army, and then help them get their message out to the world through press releases and radio programs. It is some- thing about giving voice to the voiceless.

Then we went down to the river to see the pumping station, and just by chance we came on a day when several hundred people were gathered to offer sacrifices

[11] J. Richard Middleton & Brian J. Walsh, Truth is Stranger Than It Used to Be, Biblical Faith in a Postmodern Age, Downers Grove, Illinois, Inter- varsity Press, 1995.

The real challenge is one of commitment. Peter Chao suggests that "Our commitments reveal our allegiance, our standards and our methods. Our commitments force us into consistency."[12] On the basis of a clear commitment to God and to his mission, we will be able to understand the trends and know what we ought to do.

Consulting the World

There are many other trends we could touch on, but as a professor of communication these are the ones, I find most significant. As we approach these trends from a communication perspective, we can focus on **four key questions** which have been part of my "tool box" for many years. These are the questions that sum up the communication theory we need to apply.

1. Who is my listener?
2. Where is my listener?
3. What are the needs of my listener?
4. How can I meet the needs of my listener?

These questions are easy to understand, but not always so easy to apply. It starts with a willingness to listen to the world and to the individuals we try to reach. It is also a willingness to change our thinking, our strategies, and our approaches, so that a relevant message can be communicated.

The *Evangelizing Our World Inquiry*, conducted by Dr. Luis Bush, is such an attempt. It has been a three-year long consultative process with Christian leaders in hundreds of cities to listen to their voices, especially those from the non-Western world, so that they can help construct a missiology capable of empowering the global church for participation in God's mission for the twenty-first century.

[12] Peter Chao, "Defined by Commitment" in "VantagePoint", Eagles Communications, Singapore, September 2002.

Chapter 2

The Research Purpose and Process

How do we get information that will make us relevant and effective in our church and missionary tasks? How do we achieve intelligent and effective use of media? How do we measure the results of our work? And, for the Lausanne Movement, how do we minister effectively to those who are involved in evangelism around the world? What we need is good, valid, reliable, and ongoing information.

For all our ministries, we need reliable and valid information. Broadcasters may be tempted to just count letters from listeners to judge effectiveness, or the evangelist may be satisfied with counting decisions to prove that observed changes were caused by our ministry or program, but we need to support such claims by reliable research. Results will often be caused by a combination of approaches, so if we only focus on one or two observable factors, our attention may be diverted from the real causes. The public crusade meeting may be able to count the decisions, but the primary cause or reason for a response may be the constant, faithful witness by local churches in the community.

A research system implies that research functions as an integral part of the decision-making process by management and leadership. It is an involved and responsible participation in this process. The task is one of providing meaningful and useful information that will reduce error, result in better decisions, and inspire a higher level of stewardship.

In such an integrated system, research will help the organization to focus its re- sources on the real task and the intended audience. It is, therefore, an audience- oriented approach to ministry and communication, where research is not just a tool, but an indispensable function. Fortunately, more and more churches, missions, and Christian organizations are accepting such a perspective, and they are helped to identify barriers and strengthen bridges.

What do we need to know?

The World Inquiry was prompted by the challenge of the unfinished task of evangelization. As God's people investigate to the twenty-first century, the question on the hearts of many is: "Where do we go from here in world evangelization?" There seems to be a willingness on the part of many church and mission leaders to evaluate and re-think our approaches and make the necessary changes for the future. It is on such a background that the World Inquiry has taken place. It is a de- sire to listen to the opinions of people as to what future they envision and what con- texts they are working in. A primary concern has been to get the opinions of people from countries where the church is growing, and whose voices we need to hear.

World Inquiry Purpose Statement:

The purpose of the World Inquiry is to enhance world evangelization in the twenty-first century by means of a quantitative and qualitative research inquiry using a survey and focus group consultative process to gather, compile, organize and communicate the insights of Christian leaders throughout the world.

World Inquiry Objectives:

- Listen to what God's people are saying.
- Discover the city-wide, country-wide, continent-wide and global current realities, plus the obstacles and opportunities for evangelization.
- Collect insights, beliefs, and attitudes about issues, leadership and structures related to world evangelization.
- Identify a unifying paradigm of mission (a paradigm is an archetypical example, prototype or pattern that provides a model for a process).

Expected Results: Enhance world evangelization efforts in the twenty-first century by

- increased understanding of the issues affecting world evangelization by country, region, and global factors.
- identifying what God is blessing in the city, country, and region.
- identifying major obstacles to world evangelization.
- identifying a possible unifying paradigm of mission.
- communicating the insights of the Inquiry to Christian leaders worldwide.
- cultivating prayer and praying about the matters that surfaced in the discussions.
- mobilizing God's people to participate in evangelizing our world.

Six Basic Questions

The questions followed a similar pattern between that used in the quantitative survey and that used in the qualitative survey. There are five basic sets of questions in common.

1. *What are the major external challenges facing the Church regarding evangelization in our city or country?*
2. *What are the major obstacles internal to the Church to participate effectively in world evangelization (beyond the city)?*
3. *What do you believe God is calling His people to do in world evangelization over the next 25 years?*
4. *What would be a suitable phrase (watchword) to capture the essence of world evangelization to serve as a unifying paradigm for the next 25 years?*
5. *How important are the following for Global Evangelical Structures to provide to local believers to enhance world evangelization efforts?*

A sixth set of questions in the quantitative survey are personal questions to the respondents, seeking information on the various types of evangelism that influenced their decisions to become followers of Jesus Christ.

Evangelizing Our World Inquiry Participants:

Sponsored by Fuller Theological Seminary, School of Intercultural Studies in collaboration with the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization

International Director: Luis Bush **Advisor**: Viggo Sogaard

Missiological Core Issues Consultative Group: Wilbert Shenk, Chairman

International Coalition of 120 Christian leaders: David Sang-Bok Kim, Chairman

Quantitative and Qualitative Methodology

The inquiry includes both a quantitative and a qualitative survey of the opinions of 6,970 Christian leaders in 117 cities and/or countries/regions throughout the world. The survey was conducted among non-Catholic Christians worldwide. Responses were primarily sought from respondents in regions where the church is growing most. For example, in assessing the distribution of God's people, it is found that seventy percent live outside the West, and the intended methodological objective was to gather most of the survey results from outside of the west. Special attention was given to countries with a larger number of the body of Christ who have limited freedoms,

such as India.

For the purpose of validating the findings, a quantitative survey was conducted during the first phase of the study where respondents primarily came from Latin America and Africa. The survey participants were those who also participated in the focus groups. The qualitative survey was conducted mainly in focus groups, seeking further discussion and substantiation to the numerical responses.

Focus groups were used to collect opinions, beliefs and attitudes on issues for planning and evaluation of some specific global services. The aim was to see how global efforts could assist local efforts. Focus groups provide data from a group of people much more quickly and at less cost than would be the case if everyone were interviewed separately.

Guidelines for Local Events

In order to achieve good and comprehensive responses from the focus groups, a set of guidelines were prepared:

(1) Conduct a quantitative inquiry for the individuals of the group prior to qualitative inquiry in focus groups;
(2) Cultivate an environment in the focus groups that encourages participants to share perceptions;
(3) Allow the questions to take you into deep terrain that will address issues that are not necessarily discussed on the survey;
(5) Organize the people into focus groups of five people;
(6) Get people talking and thinking about the topic as soon as possible. The beginning questions should help;
(7) Promote self-disclosure among participants to know what people really think and feel;
(8) Seek to develop a synergy in the group. Group members influence each other by responding to ideas and comments of others.

Selection of Participants

The ideal composition of the groups participating in the events should include the following:

- 25 to 35 nationals, including women
- at least 5 pastors of churches at least 5 denominational/network leaders
- at least 5 mission agency leaders
- at least 5 younger emerging leaders
- at least 5 lay leaders
- at least 5 Christian service organizations

Furthermore, it was suggested that for selection of group participants, the following criteria might be used:

- Spiritual authority - that anointing of God, which comes through gifted power, deep shaping experiences with God, and a godly character.
- Flexibility - adjusts to meet new opportunities.
- Learning posture - overcomes the tendency to plateau. Daniel set an example as we find him still studying the Bible in his old age: Daniel 9.
- Scope of influence - recognized by those of different groups within the city as a Christian leader who has exercised positive, persistent, specific influence for Christ within that city/nation/region.

Participants

Total events, both phases	117
Qualitative surveys	952
Quantitative surveys	3,077
Total participants	6,970

The qualitative survey used one questionnaire per focus group, and the quantitative survey used one questionnaire per individual. There was a total of twenty-two events in which both quantitative survey and qualitative survey were administered. These took place during phase 1, prior to the year 2003. The events in which both surveys were administered involved 1,187 participants who completed one questionnaire per individual and 290 focus groups, normally of five people per group.

Over 90% of the respondents came from Asia, Africa and Latin America. Most of the respondents are male with only 16.6% being female. Almost half of the respondents were between 36 and 50 years of age.

Regions of the World

The graph in figure 2.1 is based on the total number of respondents, including the events where no quantitative study was done.

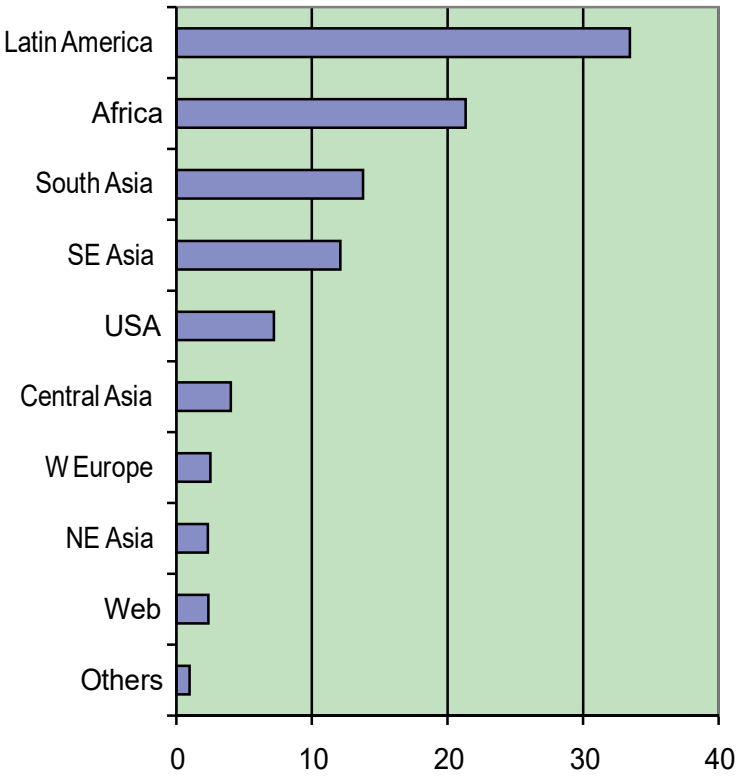


Figure 2.1: Event Participants by Region

From the graph in figure 2.1 and the map in figure 2.2, the aim of the inquiry to focus on Latin America, Africa, and Asia has been followed. This is not a random selection of cities in the regions, but a selection of sites based on personal judgment and logistical possibilities. Table 2.1 shows the actual event dates, location, size, and if both focus groups and surveys were conducted, or if only one of these activities took place.

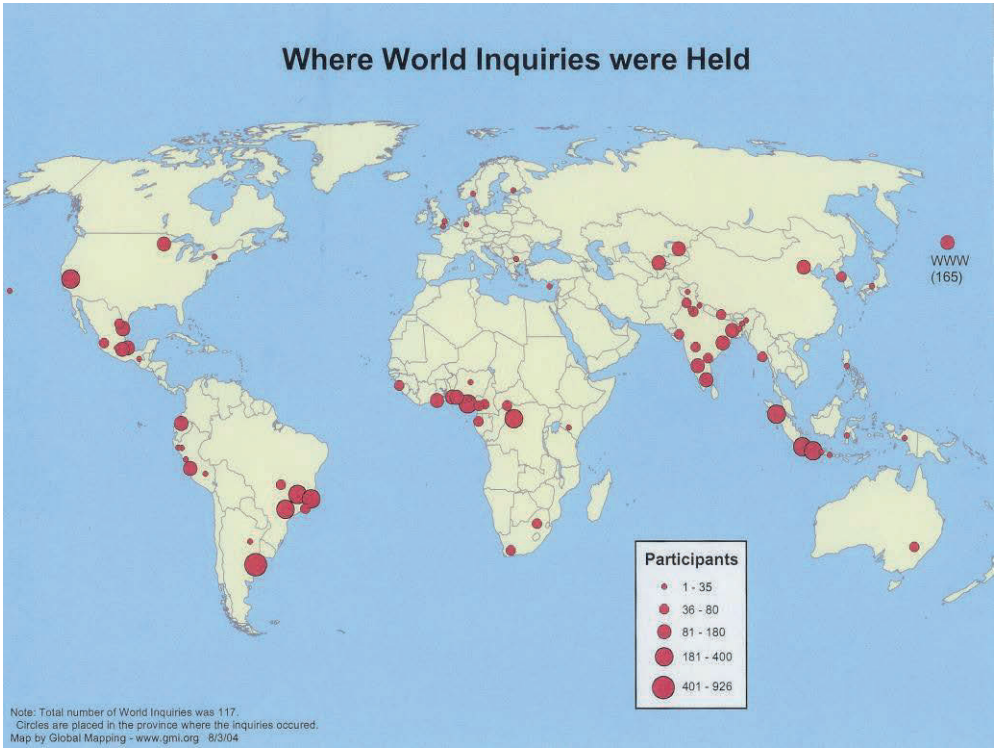


Figure 2.2: Location and Size of Events

Evangelizing our World Inquiry Events

Date	Description	Location	Participants	Qual Survey	Quan Survey
7/12/2001	Chiapas World Inquiry Among Mayan Rural	Chiapas, Mexico	17	Yes	Yes
11/20/2001	Korean Los Angeles World Inquiry	Los Angeles, USA	50	Yes	
1/11/2002	Rosario World Inquiry	Rosario, Argentina	18	Yes	Yes
1/16/2002	Buenos Aires World Inquiry	Buenos Aires, Argentina	29	Yes	Yes
1/24/2002	Lausanne Administration Committee	Los Angeles, USA	9	Yes	Yes
2/1/2002	Korean Inquiry	Seoul, South Korea	45	Yes	Yes
2/5/2002	Let the World Know China Consultation	Beijing, China	87	Yes	Yes
2/25/2002	Hispanic Los Angeles World Inquiry	Los Angeles, USA	34	Yes	Yes
3/19/2002	Intercessors Consultation	Tashkent, Uzbekistan	109	Yes	
4/11/2002	Encounter of Pastors (ENPEN)	Mar del Plata, Argentina	897	Yes	Yes

4/16/2002	Essen World Inquiry	Essen, Germany	27	Yes	Yes
4/18/2002	Norwegian World Inquiry	Oslo, Norway	11	Yes	Yes
4/19/2002	Finnish World Inquiry	Helsinki, Finland	14	Yes	Yes
5/3/2002	Nigerian Anglican Leadership World Inquiry	Zaria, Nigeria	18	Yes	
5/8/2002	WI Facilitator Fellowship Meeting	Pasadena, USA	10	Yes	
5/11/2002	Regional Consultation, Franco-phone Africa	Abidjan, Cote d'Ivoire	170	Yes	Yes
6/20/2002	West African Seminary in Lagos	Lagos, Nigeria	101	Yes	
7/2/2002	Worldwide Web	Online	165	Yes	
7/26/2002	Kenya World Inquiry	Nairobi, Kenya	26	Yes	Yes
8/9/2002	Gemena, DRC World Inquiry	Gemena, Congo,	40	Yes	Yes
8/11/2002	Karawa, DRC World Inquiry	Karawa, Congo,	22	Yes	Yes
8/19/2002	Sydney World Inquiry	Sydney, Australia	20	Yes	
8/22/2002	Gbadolite, DRC World Inquiry	Gbadolite, Congo,	199	Yes	Yes
8/24/2002	Bangui, CAR World Inquiry	Bangui, Central African Rep.	42	Yes	Yes
8/30/2002	The Kurultai of Turkic Speaking Pastors of	Almaty, Kazakhstan	106	Yes	
9/15/2002	Port Harcourt, Nigeria World Inquiry	Port Harcourt, Nigeria	286	Yes	
9/16/2002	Consultation of Nigeria FinTask	Awka, Nigeria	18	Yes	
9/19/2002	Douala, Cameroon pastor's World Inquiry	Douala, Cameroon	40	Yes	
9/20/2002	HCJB International Leadership Conference	Quito, Ecuador	34	Yes	Yes
9/21/2002	Quito World Inquiry	Quito, Ecuador	59	Yes	Yes
9/24/2002	Yaounda, Cameroon World Inquiry	Yaounda, Cameroon	48	Yes	
10/1/2002	Cotonou, Benin World Inquiry	Cotonou, Benin	158	Yes	
10/1/2002	Libreville, Gabon World Inquiry	Libreville, Gabon	67	Yes	
10/10/2002	National Consultation on Church Planting	Cape Town, South Africa	48	Yes	Yes
10/12/2002	Tswame/Pretoria World Inquiry	Pretoria, South Africa	50	Yes	Yes
10/18/2002	Worthing, England World Inquiry	Worthing, UK	33	Yes	Yes
11/5/2002	Kazakh Partnership World Inquiry	Almaty, Kazakhstan	64	Yes	
11/8/2002	South Wales World Inquiry at Newport	Newport, USA	50	Yes	Yes
11/18/2002	Cambridge, England World Inquiry	Cambridge, UK	21	Yes	Yes
11/27/2002	Metro Manila World Inquiry	Manila, Philippines	32	Yes	Yes
11/30/2002	Lima, Peru World Inquiry	Lima, Peru	35	Yes	
12/10/2002	C&MA Faculty Nyack College World Inquiry	Nyack, SA	30	Yes	
12/20/2002	Tampico, Mexico World Inquiry on Logos II	Tampico, Mexico	100	Yes	
1/6/2003	Delhi, India World Inquiry	Delhi, India	55	Yes	
1/7/2003	Kashmiri Ludhiana World Inquiry	Srinigar, India	7	Yes	
1/7/2003	Ludhiana World Inquiry	Ludhiana, India	73	Yes	
1/8/2003	District of Chandigarh World Inquiry	Chandigarh, India	20	Yes	
1/9/2003	Mumbai World Inquiry	Mumbai, India	40	Yes	

1/10/2003	Bangalore City Inquiry	Bangalore, India	85	Yes	
1/11/2003	Chennai Inquiry	Chennai, India	85	Yes	
1/13/2003	Sofia Inquiry	Sofia, Bulgaria	35	Yes	
1/13/2003	Hyderabad Inquiry	Hyderabad, India	60	Yes	
1/15/2003	Ahmedabad Inquiry	Ahmedabad, India	57	Yes	
1/16/2003	Guwahati Inquiry	Guwahati, India	22	Yes	
1/17/2003	Shillong City Inquiry	Shillong, India	20	Yes	
1/20/2003	Orissa State Inquiry of the Cities	Cuttock, India	90	Yes	
1/20/2003	Serampore City Inquiry	Serampore, India	50	Yes	
1/21/2003	MV Doulos Ghana Inquiry	Accra, Ghana	154	Yes	
1/21/2003	Kolcuta Inquiry	Kolcuta, India	50	Yes	
1/22/2003	Lucknow Inquiry	Lucknow, India	55	Yes	
1/23/2003	Uttar Pradesh Inquiry	Lucknow, India	55	Yes	
1/30/2003	Vera Cruz, Mexico World Inquiry on Logos II	Vera Cruz, Mexico	100	Yes	
2/2/2003	Cyprus Inquiry	Limassol, Cyprus	18	Yes	
2/2/2003	Katmandu Valley Inquiry	Katmandu, Nepal	60	Yes	
2/13/2003	Jakarta Inquiry	Jakarta, Indonesia	200	Yes	
2/14/2003	Medan Inquiry	Medan, Indonesia	200	Yes	
2/17/2003	East Java Inquiry	Surabaya, Indonesia	115	Yes	
2/24/2003	Delhi, Church of North India (CNI) Inquiry	Delhi, India	24	Yes	
2/27/2003	Dehra Dun Inquiry	Dehra Dun, India	24	Yes	
3/26/2003	Dhaki World Inquiry	Dhaki, Bangladesh	28	Yes	
6/6/2003	Research on World-wide Evangelization in Sao Paulo, Brazil		28	Yes	
6/6/2003	World Inquiry Guarulhos	Guarulhos, Brazil	25	Yes	
6/10/2003	World Inquiry Santo André	Santo André, Brazil	56	Yes	
6/11/2003	World Inquiry Belo Horizonte	Belo Horizonte, Brazil	180	Yes	
6/12/2003	World Inquiry Valinhos	Valinhos, Brazil	17	Yes	
6/12/2003	World Inquiry Goiania	Goiania, Brazil	66	Yes	
6/14/2003	World Inquiry Vitoria	Vitoria, Brazil	54	Yes	
6/15/2003	World Inquiry - Cachoeiro de Itapemerim – ES	Cachoeiro de	150	Yes	
6/16/2003	World Inquiry Rio de Janeiro	Rio de Janeiro, Brazil	54	Yes	
6/18/2003	World Inquiry Juiz de Fora	Juiz de Fora, Brazil	39	Yes	Yes
6/19/2003	World Inquiry Mogi das Cruzes - São Paulo	Moji das Cruzes, Brazil	135	Yes	
6/30/2003	Kyoto World Inquiry	Kyoto, Japan	23	Yes	
7/31/2003	Guinea World Inquiry - MV Doulos	Conakry, Guinea	49	Yes	
8/30/2003	Monterrey, Mexico World Inquiry	Monterrey, Mexico	45	Yes	
9/4/2003	Guadalajara World Inquiry	Guadalajara, Mexico	40	Yes	
9/4/2003	World Inquiry Sacramento Event	Sacramento, USA	24	Yes	

9/6/2003	Puebla World Inquiry for Bible Churches	Puebla, Mexico	81	Yes
9/8/2003	Mexico City World Inquiry	Mexico City, Mexico	16	Yes
9/23/2003	Kelapa Gading Inquiry	Jakarta, Indonesia	36	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Makasar, Indonesia	1	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Pasadena, USA	6	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Bandung, Indonesia	31	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Timor, Indonesia	1	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Semarang, Indonesia	18	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Sydney, Australia	26	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Surabaya, Indonesia	54	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Jayapura, Indonesia	2	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Malang, Indonesia	1	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Honolulu, USA	1	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Denpasar, Indonesia	17	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Jakarta, Indonesia	76	Yes
10/8/2003	ICCC	Los Angeles, USA	8	Yes
11/6/2003	Myanmar World Inquiry	Yangon, Myanmar	60	Yes
3/4/2004	Lodi World Inquiry	Lodi, USA	4	Yes
3/4/2004	Los Angeles Basin Inquiry	Pasadena, USA	35	Yes
3/4/2004	Fresno World Inquiry	Fresno, USA	17	Yes
3/4/2004	Modesto World Inquiry	Modesto, USA	5	Yes
3/10/2004	Atwater World Inquiry	Atwater, USA	7	Yes
3/10/2004	Merced World Inquiry	Merced, USA	5	Yes
5/5/2004	ACMC Conference	Minneapolis, USA	120	Yes
5/5/2004	Winnipeg World Inquiry at ACMC in Minneapolis, USA		16	Yes
7/1/2004	Consulta Nacional de Evangelismo	Lima, Peru	50	Yes
7/1/2004	Consulta Nacional de Evangelismo	Cajamarca, Peru	2	Yes
7/1/2004	Consulta Nacional de Evangelismo	Chiclayo, Peru	2	Yes
7/1/2004	Consulta Nacional de Evangelismo	Cuzco, Peru	2	Yes
7/1/2004	Consulta Nacional de Evangelismo	Asuncion, Peru	2	Yes
7/1/2004	Consulta Nacional de Evangelismo	Chimbote, Peru	2	Yes
7/7/2004	Back to Jerusalem Movement	Burlingame, USA	60	Yes

Table 2.1: Inquiry Events: Date, Location, Size and Activity

Confidence Factors Regarding Research Results

In research we primarily deal with two types of approaches, probability samples and non-probability samples. In a prob- ability sample you can apply the findings to the total population within given statistical parameters, but in a non-probability sample this is not possible. On the other hand, certain non-probability samples can be more useful and logistically possible than probability samples.

Why sampling? Normally, it is not possible to take a census where everybody in a population are asked for information. Sampling saves money and time and help us solve logistic problems. We therefore choose a sample, that is select a sub-set from a larger group to represent the larger group.

Concept of Representativeness: If the research results are to be useful, the basic requirement of all samples is that they are representative of the total group (universe/population) which we are studying. In order to achieve representativeness, we need to both select the ap- propriate sampling method and engage in creative sampling design.

Concept of Randomness: In a random sample, every person in the total population must have a known chance of being selected for the sample. It is not a hap- hazard or convenient way of selecting the respondents, but a carefully designed plan that will give each person a known chance of being selected. It is only when a sample is chosen by random that we can apply the findings to the total population, and we can do that within measurable error limits. It will never be possible to have a sample that precisely mirror the total population, but we will always strive for that.

Sampling and Research Design

Randomness is needed for a probability sample. In a non-probability sampling process, the selection of the sample elements is based in part on the judgment of the researcher. Not everybody in the population will have a chance of being selected, and we are therefore unable to calculate statistical sampling error in a non-probability sample.

Non-probability samples include **Convenience Samples.** A convenience sample is a situation where the re- searcher simply selects those that are conveniently available and willing to participate. It can be walking down the street and asking whoever comes by, or it could be selecting a group of church leaders who are presently attending a conference. Obviously, they will not be representative of the total population unless they have been defined as such. A seminary professor may also be tempted to use

students as a convenient way of selecting a sample. Convenience samples can be most useful in the exploratory phase of a study, and we can use it extensively for pretesting needs, but we cannot use it for the purpose of arriving at estimates concerning the whole population.

Another type of non-probability sample is the **Judgment Sample.** Judgment samples, also called purposive samples, are selected based on what a certain expert thinks are appropriate for the study. The judgment will be based on experience and knowledge about an individual and how that person is representative of the total group. We can never be sure if a judgment sample is truly representative and no statistical measure of error can be applied. On the other hand, a judgment sample will be more accurate than a convenience sample, and in some cases more useful than a random sample.

A third and often used non-probability approach is to select a **Quota Sample.** In a quota sample, steps are taken to select the sample in such a way that it represents specific sub-groups. The example could be a church denomination which has many small churches as well as a couple of large churches. If we were to choose the sample by selecting churches through a simple random approach, we may miss the large churches altogether. A quota sample will require selection of members from each of the different categories of churches, possibly an equal number from each category. In other types of quota samples, the field interviewers are asked to fill quotas so that an equal number of male and female respondents are chosen, or they could be required to fulfill specific age-level quotas

Probability Samples will include the **Simple Random Sample.** In a simple random sample all members of a population should have an equal chance of being selected. An example of this would be to write names of all members of a church on small pieces of paper, put them in a bag, and then draw the necessary numbers out of the bag. This will be a simple random sample. In practice this is often not possible. The selection of numbers in a random sample will be based on accepted statistical error and level of confidence.

An often-used approach to a probability sample (which I have often used) is to select a **Stratified Sample.** The total population is divided into strata's before actual selection of elements take place. A stratified sample is then like a quota sample in the sense that the elements are defined within specific groups. Within the strata's, participants are then randomly selected. This is a multi-stage selection process which is often used as a practical way of obtaining a random sample that is both representative and practically within reach of the interviewers.

Validity and Limitations of the World Inquiry Research. The Inquiry was not seen as a rigorous, methodologically driven research project, but rather a desire to hear God's voice through his people. Consequently, there are limitations. The World Inquiry is based on a variety of research approaches and sample selection. There is a certain dimension of quota applied, but to a large extend it is the judgment of leaders, both globally in selecting cities, and nationally in the selection of participants. Furthermore, there is a high amount of convenience, as the study was done when possible, and where other events would facilitate the study. The study is therefore a non-probability study. On the other hand, the consistency of responses between focus groups and survey responses indicate a representative sample. The judgment by leaders involved indicates a representative grouping. We should also remember that the insights from the inquiry will only give one dimension among other important inputs.

It should be recognized, though, thatthe World Inquiry meetings did not always obtain desired size of attendance and/or people mix against the targeted guide- lines. The average norm of mission agency leaders, mission pastors, missionaries and other mission-focused participants was about 20%, with 80% of other segments represented by lay leaders, younger leaders, business people, etc. This prompted broader responses within the survey questions, signifying much broader interest and needs beyond just direct mission endeavors.

The Inquiry sought to listen to three groups with special attention: the women, the younger leaders, and those directly involved in mission. As we shall see later, it was interesting to note that women are stronger in their opinion regarding external influences than men are. One reason could be that women are more active in evangelism than men are, and therefore they experience the external challenges more directly. Surprisingly, the difference in perspective between younger leaders and older leaders was minimal, as was that of leaders whose primary role was in missions when com- pared to other leaders.

Chapter 3

External Challenges Facing the Church in Evangelism

External challenges have often inspired churches to prayer and intensified evangelistic outreach, while lack of serious external problems has sometimes led to complacency.

As we look at the mission of the Church through the eyes of history, as well as taking a global view of the situation today, external challenges have had significant influence on the mission of the church. During the first centuries of the Christian Church, the believers faced enormous challenges and persecution, yet the church grew and became strong. That scenario has been repeated many times. Today we see some churches struggle with significant religious and political persecution, yet they are growing and becoming very active players in the mission of the church. At the same time, we see churches in countries with next to no external opposition becoming complacent, and their missionary involvement is declining.

We often find situations where "old churches" are faced with new challenges for which they are not prepared. One example could be the churches in Western Europe that today are faced with challenges from Islamic groups. The church members have not learned how to defend and explain their faith to such new groups. As a result, they succumb to fear and resistance, rather than accepting the challenge and see new opportunities for reaching groups that have so far been very resistant to the Gospel. New groups are often more open to the Gospel when their external contexts change, but it does re- quire the church to be open and to change where changes are needed.

From a global perspective we see many challenges from the context in which the churches find themselves. In the Global Inquiry, which has been supervised by Dr. Luis Bush, an attempt has been made at discovering the challenges we are facing today. The purpose is, of course, to identify areas of need and possibilities, and in turn prepare we for meeting such challenges. This may involve new structures, new training programs, new approaches, and above all new commitments to the task.

The Questions

The first set of questions in both the Survey and in the Focus Groups focused on the external challenges facing the Church in relation to evangelization. The basic question was:

> *What are the major external challenges facing the Church regarding evangelization in our city or country?*

Based on extensive initial research, consultations, and discussions with key persons, the following categories were provided for responses:

1. Globalization – the internationalizing of our shrinking world due to rapid communication toward a common culture
2. Racial tension
3. Pluralism – the coexistence within the one political community of groups who hold incompatible views regarding religion
4. Illiteracy
5. Post-Modernity – exhaustion of modernity. It celebrates diversity, fragmentation, ambivalence
6. Religious fundamentalism
7. Injustice caused by persecution or political opposition
8. Technological advances
9. Unreached linguistic and ethno-cultural peoples
10. Unreached geographic areas
11. Unreached social groupings – such as the youth
12. AIDS and other major diseases
13. Materialism/distraction
14. Relevance of the Christian Faith
15. Food and water

On the individual questionnaires used in the Survey, respondents were given a 5-point scale for responses from" Most *Important"* to *"Least Important"*.

On the following graph, figure 3.1, we have included both the results of responses to" Most *Important"*, as well as the combined results of two top options, that is *"Most Important"* and *"Very Important"*.

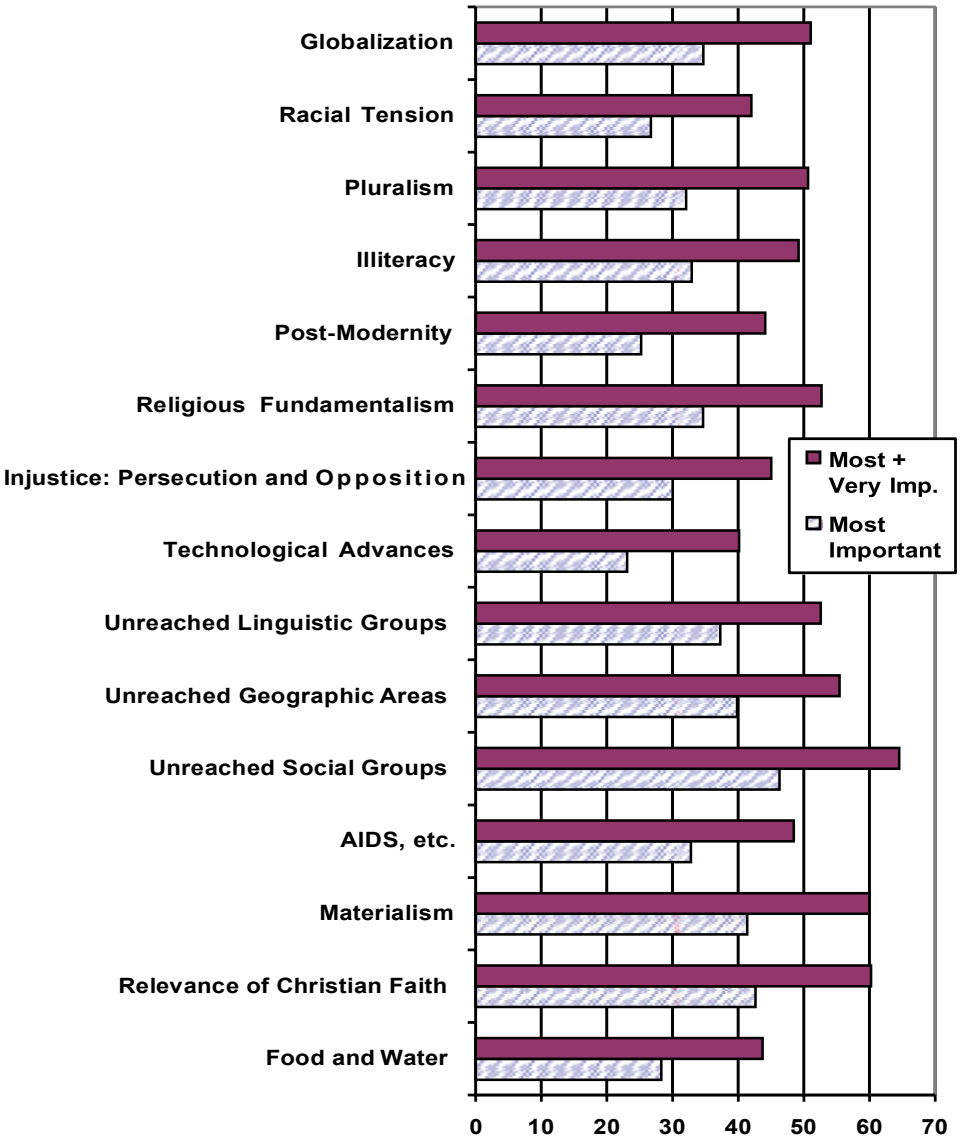


Figure 3.1: Percentage of External Challenges Prioritized (Survey)

The survey data was obtained prior to focus group discussions. In the focus groups, a slightly different approach was followed. The questions are answered by groups, and they were to choose their first three choices. In this way, we do not have the level of importance of each topic, but an ordering of the priorities regarding these topics. That may not be too significant, but when we base it on the strength given to each topic in the Survey, we find this very important and significant.

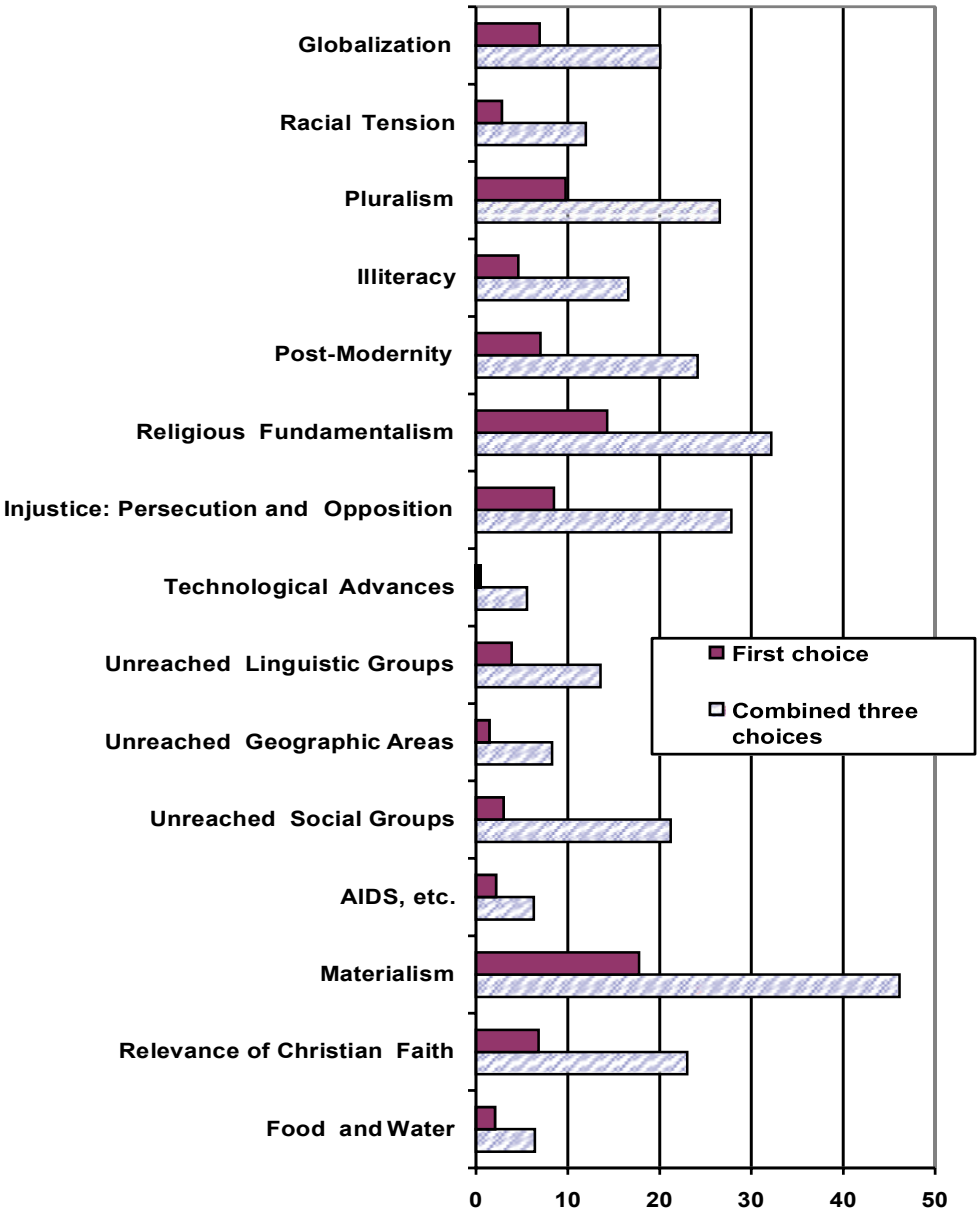


Figure 3.2: Percentage of External Challenges Prioritized (Focus Groups)

Least Important External Challenges

	Least Important External Challenge	Least Important
1.	Materialism	5.10%
2.	Religious fundamentalism	5.33%
3.	Persecution and Injustice	9.62%
4.	Pluralism	7.51%
5.	Post-Modernity	7.51%
6.	Relevance of the Christian faith	4.13%
7.	Unreached social groupings	3.90%
8.	Globalization	9.46%
9.	Illiteracy	10.43%
10.	Unreached ethnic people groups	6.04%
11.	Racial tension	8.87%
12.	Unreached geographic areas	6.99%
13.	Food and water	14.17%
14.	AIDS and major diseases	8.61%
15.	Advanced technology	11.50%

Table 3.1: Least Important (Survey)

As already mentioned, the forced choice of the three most important issues does not reflect the level of importance. The survey shows very high importance for almost all topics, so the issues given lower priority by focus groups, are still very important overall. The item with lowest importance was still given a 40.1% as most or next to most important in the Survey. This is illustrated on table 3.1, which indicates how few gave low priority to any of the items. This means that all areas chosen for the research were important external factors. The items with highest score regarding "*Least Important"* were Food and Water (14.17%), but other items were between 2.37% and 11.50%.

Sub-groups

It is not possible to sub-divide responses from Focus groups into gender, age, or leadership positions. The Survey results can be subdivided, but we find that over- all there is a strong unified trend. Only when it comes to regional differences, as illustrated below, do we see significant divergent responses.

Gender: It is interesting to note that, apart from one area (religious fundamentalism), women are stronger in their opinion regarding external influences than men are. One reason could be that women are more active in evangelism and therefore they experience the external challenges more directly.

Younger Leaders: There is very little difference in the responses when com- paring those below thirty-five and those above thirty-five years of age. We can note, though, that those above 35 see more traditional issues influencing the church, like materialism, relevance of the Christian Faith, and Food and Water, while those below 35 are a little stronger on issues such as Religious Fundamentalism, Illiteracy and Post-Modernism.

Mission Leaders: The responses from mission leaders follow the same trends as for other groups. In most cases, their responses show slightly less importance to the external challenges than the rest of the respondents, but the differences are in most cases insignificant.

Overall, we find that materialism and religious fundamentalism are global concerns, and they are clearly seen as the greatest challenges to the church in its mission of evangelization. Materialism as a distraction ranks first. As a natural sequence to religious fundamentalism we have injustice caused by persecution or political opposition which ranks third. All are struggling with communicating the relevancy of the Christian faith, and there are large unreached social groups, especially the youth. A trio of external challenges cluster around the twenty-first century contextual realities of Globalization, Pluralism and Post-Modernity.

Ranking of Importance of External Influences

Based on the total results of the Focus groups, we can rank the responses as in table 3.2.

Rank Comb.	External Challenge	First choice	Combined three choices
1.	Materialism	17.75%	46,11%
2.	Religious fundamentalism	14,28%	32,14%
3.	Persecution and Injustice	8,50%	27,83%
4.	Pluralism	9,76%	26,57%
5.	Post-Modernism	7,03%	24,15%
6.	Relevance of the Christian faith	6,82%	23,00%
7.	Unreached social groupings	3,04%	21,21%
8.	Globalization	6,93%	20,06%
9.	Illiteracy	4,62%	16,59%
10.	Unreached ethnic people groups	3,88%	13,55%
11.	Racial tension	2,83%	11,97%
12.	Unreached geographic areas	1,47%	8,29%
13.	Food and water	2,10%	6,40%
14.	AIDS and major diseases	2,20%	6,30%
15.	Advanced technology	0.52%	5,56%

Table 3.2: Ranking of External Challenges (Focus Groups)

Comparing Results Between Continents

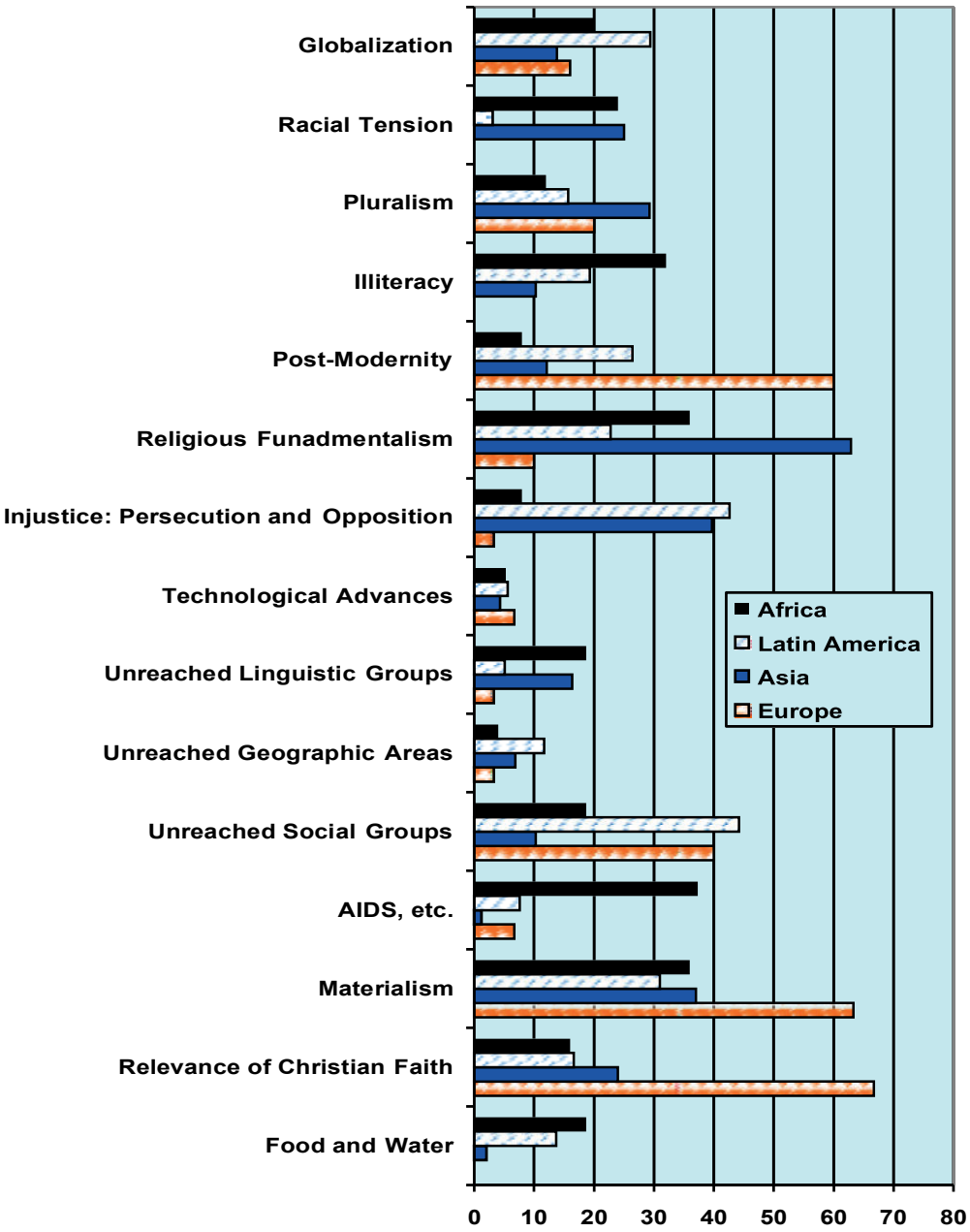


Figure 3.3: External Influences Compared by Continent (Survey)

Regional Variations on External Influences

The responses of leaders from different countries and regions show significant variations, as the local contexts vary, and the problems church leaders are con- fronted with change from country to country.

Africa:

In Africa, AIDS ranks as the highest external challenge, and it is proportionally a greater challenge to African churches than it is for the other regions. The curse that this epidemic has caused to church- es in many countries is beyond our worst imaginations. Churches suffer from the sorrow in their communities, and they suffer directly when church members succumb to the virus. Many other problems follow as a result. There are widows to take care of and even more orphans that need food and shelter, as well as schooling. At the same time, church in- come suffers as supporting members die from their infections.

Religious fundamentalism ranks very high in many countries in the region, often combined with racial tension which is causing strife all over the continent.

Another major influence is illiteracy. It has been estimated by informal research that in several countries, printed material is only effective for 10 to 15% of the population. Even though the issue of lack of food and water is prevalent in the news, and is a major challenge in many countries, materialism also ranks fairly high.

As a few examples, we could mention that the one group in Swaziland indicated AIDS as the most serious challenge, followed by Social Groups (Youth). The focus groups in Kenya saw Illiteracy, Technological Advances, and AIDS as most serious external challenges. In Zambia AIDS was again at the top together with Relevancy of Christian Faith, followed by issues like Unreached Groups.

Latin America:

In the Latin American region “Unreached Social Groups” rank highest. As the question had the added words, “such as youth”, we should expect that the focus and the basic reason for the high response to this challenge is the youth. There is a strong concern for reaching the youth of the region.

The topic of Persecution and Injustice also received a very high rating. Many countries in Latin America experience injustice, and the evangelical churches faces opposition in several counties. In Argentina, for example, Persecution and Injustice ranks highest.

More modern issues of Materialism, Globalization, and Post-Modernity are also issues that leaders in the region are facing.

Asia:
In Asia, it is Religious Fundamentalism that has the highest rating with more than 60%. It should be noted that most respondents come from two countries in Asia. That is India and Indonesia. In Indonesia the very highest score is given to Religious Fundamentalism, followed by Persecution and Injustice. Indonesia is a country where Islamic fundamentalists are very active, and this has led to unfortunate fighting and persecution in many parts of the country. In India Religious Fundamentalism is also the most important external challenge with four times as high a score as the next issue which is Racial Tension. It is basically the op- position from fundamentalist Hindu groups that causes concern.

Persecution and Injustice ranks high as the highest combined score for the Asia region. In most countries of Asia evangelistic activities are severely curtailed, and in several others directly prohibited.
Materialism, Pluralism, and Relevance of Christian Faith were also very important issues in Asia. Chinese groups gave highest score to Post Modernity and Globalization, followed by Religious Fundamentalism and Post-Modernity.

Europe:
The number of Europeans involved in the Inquiry is comparatively very small, as the focus was on Africa, Latin America, and Asia. Based on the responses received, we can see significant differences to that of other regions. In the "Christian" Europe, it is Relevance of Christian Faith that receives the highest rating as an external challenge to evangelism.

Materialism and Post-Modernity also rank very high, as the church seems unprepared for ministry in our present world. There is a high concern for Un- reached Social Groups which probably is also since young people to a large extent turn their back on the Church.

Comments to Responses to External Challenges to the Church in Evangelism

It has already been noted that all issues are important. In the quantitative survey no item received less than 40% in the combined score of Most Important and Very Important. As the survey questionnaires were filled out individually prior to discussions in groups, the responses will reflect what people think. When it comes to prioritizing, there is obviously a stronger influence from the views of others, as these are filled out after group discussions. In the following, a brief review is given to each item chosen for this research.

1: Globalization

It has been stated that the world is be- coming a Global Village. This is only partly true. It would be more accurate to say that each village has become a global village in the sense that there is access to each village for those with power and will to utilize that. In a village all have equal access to news dissemination, but this is not the case today. Members of churches will therefore feel economic conditions change. In many places people are out of work as multi- national companies, under the disguise of free trade policies, undercut local pro- ductions and economics. In the research, we find globalization as a high challenge to the church in evangelism.

2. Racial Tension

According to the data, this is especially an issue in Asia and Africa, where racial wars are prevalent, but we are experiencing similar challenges in many countries. Even though the issue is not rated as important in Europe, we have seen ethnic cleansing and racial tension in the Balkans, and racism is becoming a serious issue all over the Continent. In the Middle East we have the extremely sad situation of racism and resulting tensions and fighting. The situation is different from country to country. In some countries racism forces churches to take a stand for equality, in other cases they are forced to "play along". This has significant implications for evangelism.

3. Pluralism

The issue of pluralism is obviously a strong challenge. On the one hand it forces churches to focus on the unique- ness of Christ, and on the other hand give freedom of expression and equal rights to all. The issue is a very relevant topic in several Asian countries, and the experiences they have in this regard may be helpful lessons for Europeans who are now facing the same issues.

4. Illiteracy

This issue is rated as one of the highest challenges in Africa, but it is also a significant issue in South Asia and to a certain extent in the rest of Asia. Official literacy rates are high in many countries with India having up to half a billion non- literates, but actual reading is also de- creasing drastically in many other countries. Yet the church and its approach to evangelization is primarily based on printed material, and sermons are usually structured on linear thinking. This global challenge is therefore not just a matter of literacy, but of functional literacy, and it will most likely be one of the biggest challenges to evangelism and production of evangelistic material in the coming years.

5. Post-Modernity

The data indicate this as a very important issue in Europe, and a significant challenge in Latin America. This may be due to traditional leadership structures which are challenged. It will also significantly challenge the evangelistic approaches which we have used. Post-modern youth disregards one-way speeches and re- quests dialogue and involvement. That is very encouraging as it gets much closer to the biblical illustrations of good communication. Where the church lives up to that challenge, we see the churches filling up with many young people.

6. Religious Fundamentalism

This has now become a global concern, and it is rated high by all concerned. It is unclear, though, what is the real issue. Many churches and mission groups are facing persecution from fundamentalist groups. On the other hand, certain Chris- tian fundamentalist groups are also today providing serious challenges in many situations.

7. Injustice and Persecution

This takes on a variety of forms in the different countries, but it is felt as a real challenge to churches involved in evangelism in Asia and Latin America. In Latin America the evangelical churches may experience injustice from Catholic leadership, yet in other places there is good and helpful cooperation between Protestants and Catholics. Persecution in Asia is in some countries coming from religious groups, but in other Marxist based governments from state laws and police harassment.

8. Technological Advances

This item was given a surprisingly low priority by all regions. This may be since respondents had to choose, so we do not have a good response from the focus groups. The technological advances give significant challenges in many countries. The advent of satellite television and computer-based technology has changed whole societies and accepted standards of behavior. Churches are seeing programs on television which they would like to imitate, but they do not have the financial capacity to do so. In rural and very poor churches, all the pastor can do is preach, and those who can read can participate in Bible studies. In this way, the majority is often left without any help. At the same time, we can notice that the technological advances have given us the possibilities of communicating the Scriptures to all.

9. Unreached Ethno-Cultural and Linguistic Groups

This issue was given low priority by focus groups, but the survey shows significant interest in this topic. The challenge may not have as high an interest today as we saw earlier. This may be due to our present-day focus on the immediate neighborhood of

churches.

10. Unreached Geographical Areas
It is quite possible that the respondents have understood this as a similar question to that above. It has received an overall low importance by the focus groups. In the survey, it did receive very high importance. The low response from focus groups may again be due to the limitation of three choices. In general, there are few geographical areas without a church, but on the other hand if we follow the older definitions of "unreached", then most of the world is un- reached.

11. Unreached Social Groups
In the survey "Unreached Social Groups such as youth" received the highest rating, but much less as a priority in the focus groups. There is a high variation between the regions, though, with Europe and Latin America giving it very high priority, possibly due to focus on the youth. There is a growing concern that the churches are not reaching the youth of today. From the study of young people in several countries, the basic problems are related to the approach's churches use in evangelism and in the worship services. This external challenge is therefore also a significant internal challenge.

12. AIDS and other Major Diseases Overall this was given low priority, but in Africa it had the highest ranking. Churches seem to have neglected this issue in many countries, but due to the extent of the infection, African churches have faced up to the situation, and it has influenced much of the work and approaches. The number of members who die and the staggering number of or- phans is a significant challenge to their leadership and financial capacities.

13. Materialism
Based on the total responses, this is the most serious external problem. It is high all over, and it seems to seriously influence the way in which evangelism takes place or does not take place. The poor are often neglected in our search for material goods. It is serious in Europe, but all regions suffer. Affluent churches seem to be less committed to evangelism than poor churches, as people are more concerned about personal gain and welfare than helping those in need. Churches seem to need a real challenge from Scripture where we see Jesus giving special attention to the poor and the outcast.

14. Relevance of the Christian Faith This is the highest rating by focus groups in Europe, and possibly in other areas with old mainline churches where members have

not been taught the fundamentals of the Christian faith, and how to apply that to daily living. As immigrant groups with other beliefs are coming into Europe as refugees, the Christians are asked to defend their faith and explain the Gospel.

15. Food and Water

Overall, this is not an issue of high priority by focus groups, but it did receive high importance in Africa and Latin America. The present focus on holistic approaches should highlight this issue much more in the future. Churches can- not remain silent when millions are starving and dying of hunger. *Good news* for the poor will include physical as well as spiritual food to the many who suffer, and in that context, the Gospel will become a living reality.

Chapter 4

Internal Obstacles to Effective Evangelization

In the previous chapter, we looked at data related to external influences on world evangelization. In this chapter the attention is drawn to internal problems which may hinder actual participation in world evangelization by a church. But what is seen as problems by church leadership have often proved to be insignificant by those whose hearts are burning for winning people for Christ.

The Evangelizing Church

In his insightful and prophetic text, ChurchNext,[13] Dr. Eddie Gibbs describes nine areas where change needs to take place in the western churches if they are to reach out to people of the future. The topics dealt with by Dr. Gibbs include, "From Living in the Past to Engaging with the Present", "From Bureaucratic Hierarchies to Apostolic Networks", "From Dead Orthodoxy to Living Faith", "From Attracting a Crowd to Seeking the Lost" and "From Generic Congregations to Incarnational Communities". These topics are all related to the western church, but they could probably be applied to other parts of the world as well. In the World Inquiry Luis Bush has attempted to look at some of the same issues, but the focus has been Africa, Latin America, and Asia.

One of the questions above deals with "living in the past rather than engaging the present" which means that approaches are not appropriate for the future. We also tend to dwell on history rather than seeing the possibilities. This reminds me of the meeting Dr. Leighton Ford and I had in the office of the East German foreign minister in 1988, as we sought permission to have delegates come to the Lausanne conference in Manila. The minister expressed his concern this way, "When we meet with local church leaders, they always have history sitting next to them." In other words, they looked at the past rather than looking at the opportunities of the present.

This all relates to compassion for the lost. It may be that people are so over- whelmed with the needs of the world which they are confronted with daily in the news on television that they cannot absorb any more. But a compassion for the lost and needy in our world will need to follow the example of Jesus and *bring good news to the poor.*

[13] Eddie Gibbs, ChurchNext, InterVarsity Press, 2000.

In history of mission we find those burning souls that cannot be stopped, but mission is their identity, and reaching the lost is their burning compassion.

This all calls for good leadership that are prepared to seek new approaches and work on new strategies. The present interest in incarnational communities and incarnational approaches are therefore encouraging. We find that where the missionary or evangelist lives among the people, works with them, cries with them and enjoys life with them, then there is openness for listening, and the Gospel is seen and demonstrated as being relevant to their lives. Such "seeker- sensitive" approaches lead to participation in life and in church.

The basic question in Luis Bush's research was:

What are the major obstacles internal to the Church to participate effectively in world evangelization?

The same questions were treated in both the survey and in the focus groups. Respondents were asked to indicate how big a problem the following potential obstacles were to their involvement in world evangelization:

1. Lack of money
2. Lack of effective leadership
3. Lack of vision and understanding
4. Lack of workers
5. Lack of training of workers
6. Lack of appreciation by outsiders of contextualized local distinctives
7. Opposition from inside the church
8. Family issues
9. Lack of inspiration and united prayer
10. Lack of good research and information on the remaining task
11. Lack of effective cooperation and coordinated action between mission agencies
12. Lack of common goals or strategies for world evangelization
13. Unhealthy churches that are not able to reproduce themselves

The survey respondents indicated how big a problem each item was, while the focus groups selected the first three priorities, or first, second, and third choices only regarding

what is seen as most serious internal obstacles to world evangelization. There was a space for "other issues," but very few used that option, so we can conclude that the topics chosen pretty much cover the issues. Responses to Internal Obstacles by Focus Groups

We can see from Figure 4.1 that there is a clear focus on the lack of vision, lack of inspiration and united prayer, and lack of effective leadership. Lack of money is also seen as a serious internal obstacle. Fully one-fifth of all the possible responses by the combined results of all focus groups identified lack of vision as the greatest need for the Church in fulfilling its mandate of evangelization.

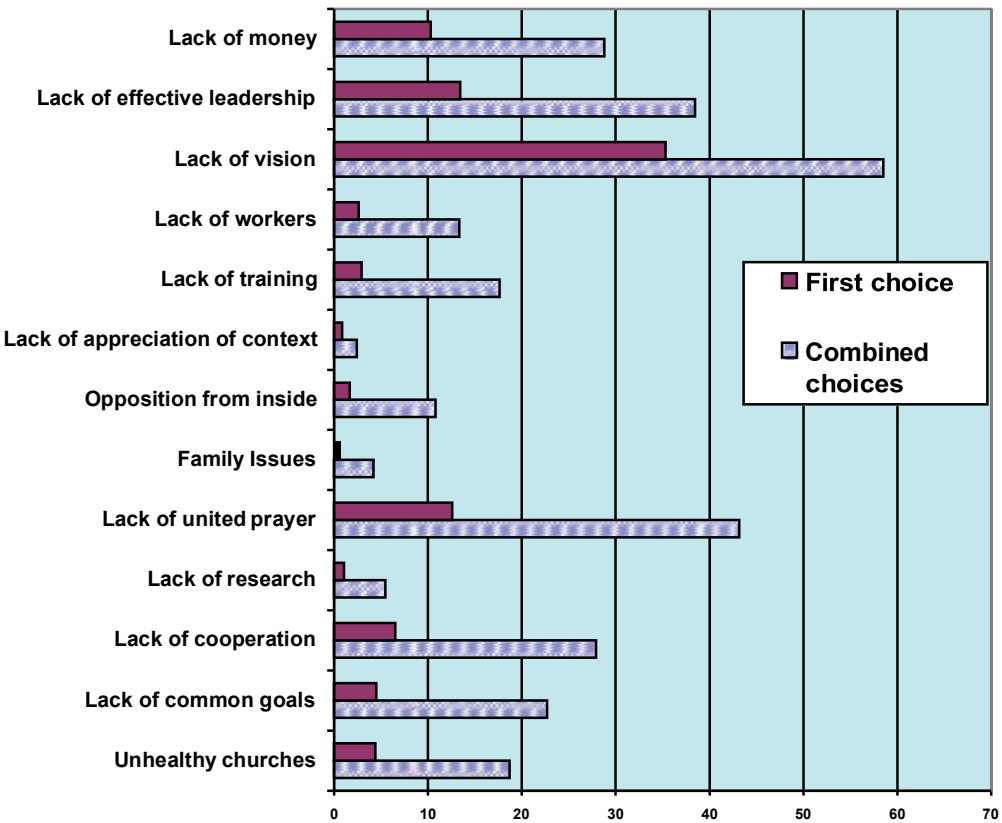


Figure 4.1: Prioritizing the Importance of Internal Obstacles (Focus Groups)

As in the review of external obstacles, we need to turn to the survey for a reading of the seriousness and the level of internal problems as felt by the participants. Figure 4.2 shows the responses, based on "Most Important" and the combined score of "Most Important" and "Very Important." The data clearly indicate that churches and missions are facing some very significant and extensive problems.

Women responded with slightly stronger responses to all points apart from the last question regarding "Unhealthy Churches," where women gave a slightly lower response than the men. There was no significant difference between the responses of those below thirty-five years of age and those above thirty-five years of age.

Mission leaders responded slightly lower than the rest of the respondents on all questions apart from the issue of vision. Here mission leaders gave a slightly higher response. In general, their responses have the same trends as the rest of the respondents, but as participants in the Inquiry pretty much were all leaders, we should not expect significant differences

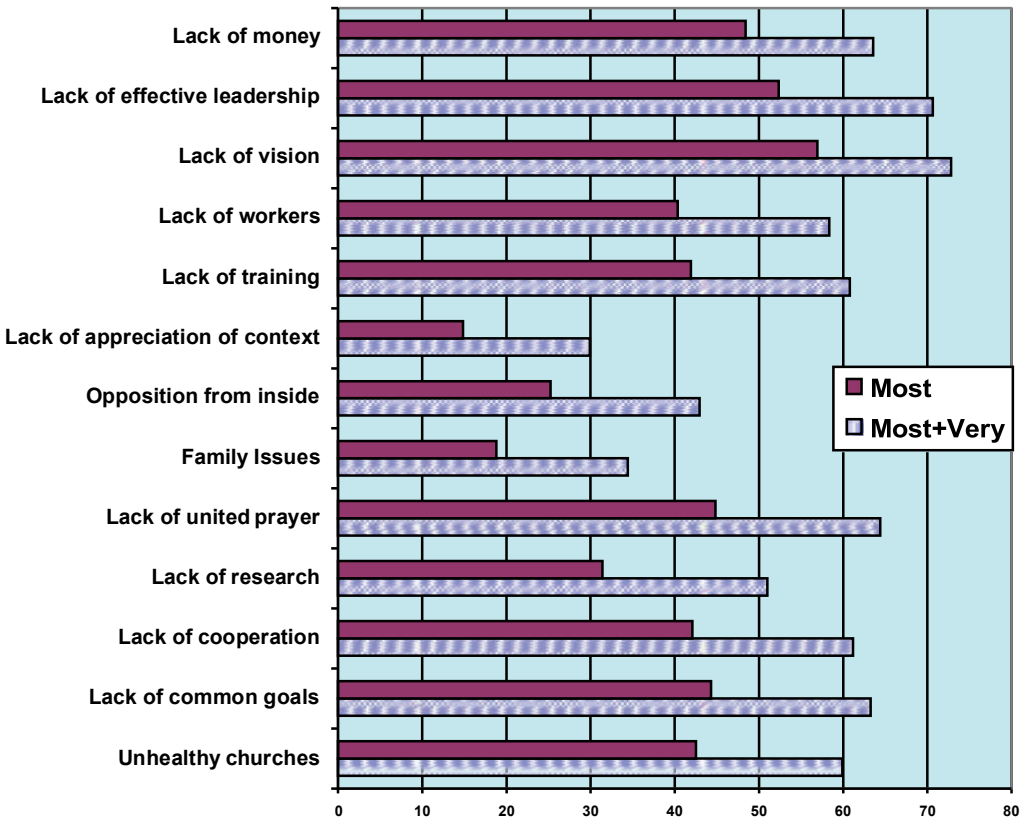


Figure 4.2: Importance of Internal Obstacles (Survey)

Comparison of Responses to Internal Obstacles by Regions

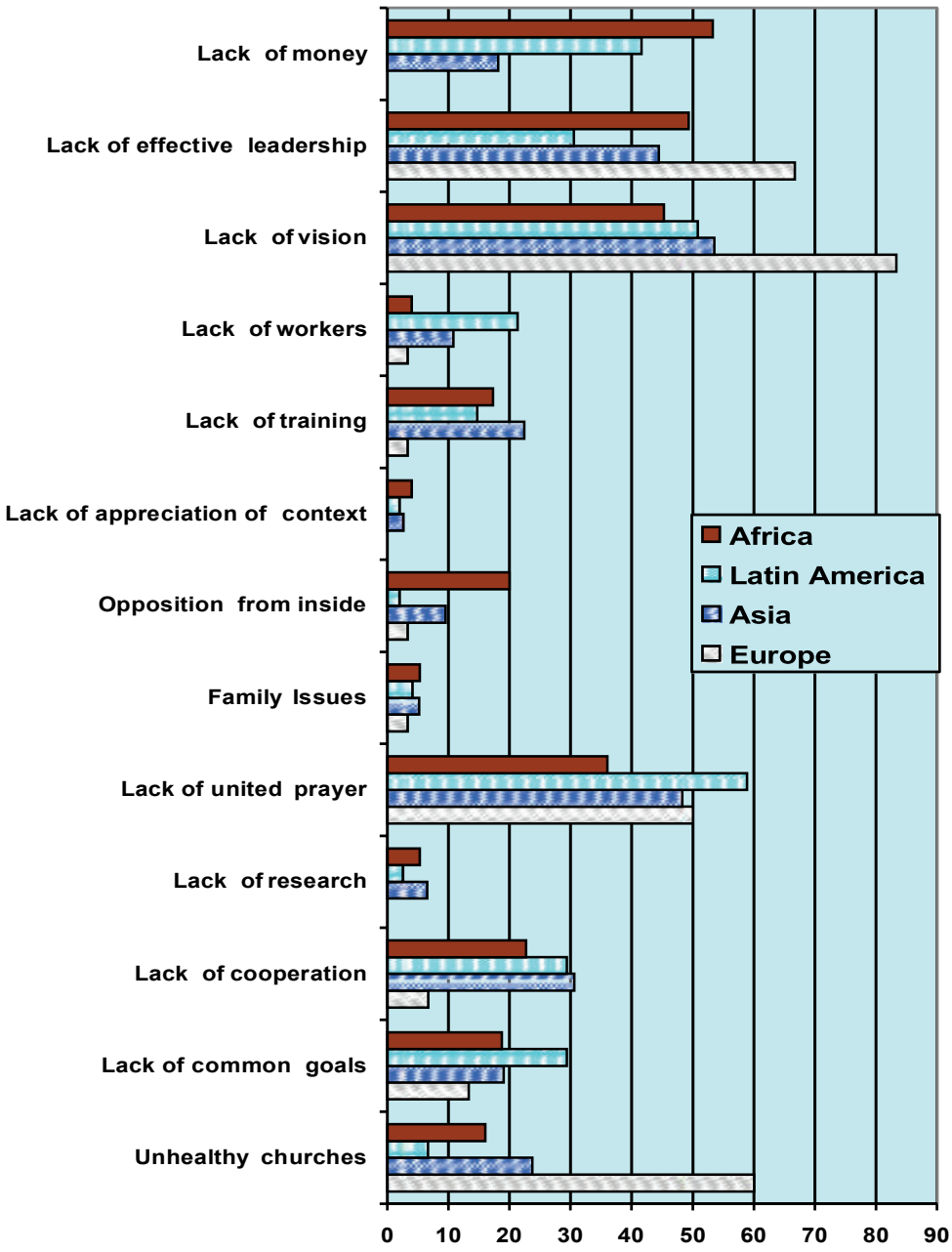


Figure 4.3 Comparing Internal Problems by Continents (Survey)

Looking at the overall responses, we find that all issues are important and seen as obstacles. On table 4.1 we have included the items that in the survey were listed as "not a problem". The responses are very low which indicate that all issues are serious challenges for churches all over the world.

Internal Challenges	Not a problem
Lack of money	5.17%
Lack of effective leadership	2.63%
Lack of vision	2.37%
Lack of workers	5.88%
Lack of training of workers	3.51%
Lack of appreciation by outsiders	12.32%
Opposition from inside the church	6.17%
Family issues	8.84%
Lack of inspiration and united prayer	3.35%
Lack of research	5.00%
Lack of cooperation	3.25%
Lack of goals	2.79%
Churches that can't reproduce	3.57%

Table 4.1: Percentage of Issues seen as not a Problem

Comments to Responses regarding Internal Challenges to the Church in Evangelism

The Inquiry set out to study what the major obstacles are to the Church if it is to participate effectively in world evangelization. Based on preliminary research and consultations, thirteen different is- sues were chosen, and the responses have been illustrated in figures 4.1, 2, 3. As we should expect, there are differences between the different regions, and some of these differences are highlighted in the comments below.

1. Lack of Money

With the availability of funds, we can often do much more, and based on the combined results, this issue gets the fourth highest score by the respondents. The survey responses from the Africa region put this item as the most serious internal problem facing the church in evangelism. It also gets a high rating by respondents from Latin America. It is quite clear that there is a very large disparity of money from country to country.

It is a question, though, how much this influences evangelism. Looking at the global situation, it does call for a rethinking of this issue. One organization in India started for only 20 years ago without money. Today they have 13,500 workers and more than a million people have become members of their churches. On the other hand, we find that there are churches in Europe that do not lack funds, but their involvement in mission is declining.

2. Lack of Effective Leadership

This issue gets the second highest rating and as such indicates a very serious obstacle to world evangelization. The trend is the same for all regions, but it is rather difficult to judge the meaning of this issue. It may be an indicator of the fact that leaders are not willing to fight for issues, or to go out in front. Today there are more leadership courses than we ever had in the history of the church. It is also clear that the issue of leadership and leadership development is gaining more and more momentum, understanding, and support. Good leaders are those who make things happen, and when they are well trained through ongoing programs and mentorship, they become vital to the mission of the church. The very high rating it may indicate that the training programs that exist have not yet been made available to most church leaders.

3. Lack of Vision and Understanding The research data indicate that lack of vision is seen as the very most serious internal obstacle to evangelization, so it is tempting to quote Prov.29:18, “Where there is no vision, people perish”. It is a question of challenge.

Our time is a time when we do not seem to encourage vision and new advances in the western world. Fortunately, brothers and sisters in the "south" have taken up the torch and gone out in front with vision and dedication. It is not a question of God not speaking, but it is a problem of us not listening to his call. When a leader goes out in front with vision, people will follow.

Mission motivation is a basic requirement for mission involvement. In our present world, the call is for local evangelism and church expansion, and voices for world mission or world evangelization seem to have been reduced significantly during the last decades. It is, of course, a very vital sign of church life when a local church becomes concerned for its immediate context, but it is also a sign of diminishing vision when concern for the rest of the world seems lacking.

4. Lack of Workers
The issue of "Lack of Workers" was given a comparatively low rating. It does look as if it is not the availability of workers, but rather the willingness of workers and the willingness of supporting constituencies that provides the problems. If finances are available, there would probably also be the necessary workers. A trend is that many young people are willing to give a year or two, but it is difficult to find workers that dedicate their lives to full-time service.

5. Lack of Training of Workers
Again, the training of workers was given a low priority by the focus groups. It may indicate a lack of understanding when it comes to intercultural ministry, as there today is a tendency to send young people out in short term assignments without proper training. The call for training comes today from those who are seriously engaged in evangelism and holistic mission, and when looking at the world, we find few opportunities for training in cross-cultural evangelism.

6. Lack of Appreciation by Outsiders of Contextualized Local Distinctives This item was given absolute lowest priority. There are still organizations that do not seem to recognize the work of local leaders and their contextualized approaches, but the data seems to indicate that there is a new understanding of contextualization and the development of local theology and local approaches. We can therefore see new ministries, using new approaches being recognized and appreciated by outsiders.

7. Opposition from Inside the Church Overall the data does not indicate that this is a serious obstacle to involvement by the church in evangelism. It is obvious that where the problem exists, it is primarily a local problem. Even within one country we find differences among churches within the same denomination. In some churches, there is a strong sup- port for changes, while in others there is opposition from traditional leadership structures and ecclesiastical authorities.

8. Family Issues

In no region was this selected as a priority item. During a recent evaluation trip to an African country, we received quite strong responses regarding an evangelistic approach that focused on the individual. There was a strong call to make the family the focus of evangelism.

Another way family issues come into the picture relate to foreign missionaries where the education of children often keeps families home in their own countries for extended periods of time. In other countries, local missionaries are often faced with serious family issues regarding the living conditions in their areas of service.

9. Lack of Inspiration and United Prayer

The lack of inspiration and united prayer is listed as a serious issue by all the groups. In the focus groups it received second highest ranking. The question is a double-barreled question, though, so it is difficult to judge if the respondents focused on the lack of inspiration or the lack of prayer.

Most likely the focus was on prayer, and this is also the title on the graphs. This is a difficult topic to handle in this context, as prayer is an issue with God. All results ultimately depend on God and His Spirit, so it is not possible for us human beings to evaluate if there is "enough" prayer. Jesus asked us to pray always. Maybe the respondents felt that they could not get people to prayer meetings, or that prayer seemed to be lacking in their churches and in the homes.

10. Lack of Good Research and Information on the Remaining Task

The question is two-sided and as such probably limits the responses. It was one of the lowest priorities in the focus groups. Everybody seems to feel that they are well supplied with information. On the other hand, it is also obvious from the general situation in the world, that very few agencies use good and appropriated research approaches to get useful information for the planning and execution of mission objectives. The lack of such information often leads to decisions that are based on feelings rather than on facts. A major problem is the lack of awareness of the possibility and usefulness of good research.

11. Lack of Effective Cooperation and Coordinated Action between Mission Agencies

Even though few respondents or focus groups indicated this issue as a serious problem, it did show significant importance among the top three issues in Africa, Asia, and Latin America. The lack of cooperation often leads to overlapping ministries. The question may be more due to lack of communication between the agencies, than lack of willingness to actual cooperation. It has been seen that when an external agency brings complementary agencies together, the cumulative results are increased significantly. It is a question of focusing on the things that each agency does best. It is there- fore encouraging that we see an increasing interest in working together for mutual benefits and encouragements. We must confess, though, that networks, partnerships, and cooperation are not characteristics of much mission in the world today. The data indicate an awareness of the problem, so we should expect new initiatives taken for cooperation and partnerships.

12. Lack of Common Goals or Strategies for World Evangelization

This issue does, of course, relate directly to the question of cooperation. The topic received a high rating in the focus groups, but it is clear from the survey data that the issue is primarily experienced by respondents in non-western countries.

It is often difficult for one of the involved agencies to take the initiative for establishing common goals, but we can note with thankfulness that through the years, the Lausanne movement has been instrumental in the development of com- mon strategies. The work of Senior Associates provided significant input in this area, and it proved that there is a willingness among leaders to work together when someone else takes the initiative.

13. Unhealthy Churches that is not able to Reproduce themselves

This is a rather sad item and it received the third highest rating in the European survey. We do need to remember, though, that the data is based on personal feelings and not on objective criteria or statistical data. In Europe we have huge national churches where it is very difficult to deal with mission issues, as some churches are church- es for geographical areas, and as such mission is not an issue to be discussed. In countries with small minority churches, the situation is much clearer.

We can note, though, that there is an increasing call for "Living Faith" from post-modern youth. They require living demonstrations of stated creeds, rather than just having such faith described in church constitutions. Living faith is also an issue related to the in- creasing interest in holistic mission where the total needs of human beings are taken seriously.

Chapter 5

The Future Focus

In a rapidly changing world, 25 years is a long time, but this is what the research called for. We should expect, though, that responses are pretty much based on what the respondents see as needs today and the immediate future. When looking at the data, the words of the song "The Old Time Religion is Good Enough for Me" come to mind, as it is pretty much a return to a focus on the "old time" approaches and emphasis.

The basic question was:

> *What do you believe God is calling His people to do in world evangelization over the next twenty-five years?*

The Focus groups were asked to select only three of the following activities, ranking their responses with a first, second, and third choice:

Question	**First Choice**	**Combined Choices**
Q37. Preach the gospel to every person using personal evangelism	**23.42%**	**48.73%**
Q38. Make the Scriptures and gospel message available in every language for both literate and non-reading by radio, TV, the Jesus Film, Bible translation and distribution, and by CD	**17.75%**	**48.63%**
Q40. Seek social transformation – seeking positive change in the whole of human life materially, socially, and spiritually, by recovering our identity as hu- man beings created in the image of God and discovering our true vocation as productive stewards, faith- fully caring for our world and people.	**17.75%**	**46.84%**

Q41. For the church to be a prophetic voice to the city	**8.29%**	**32.14%**
Q46. Get the church involved in things like • *developing a primary health care network* • *improving the health of communities* • *teaching adults, and especially women, to read and write* • *establishing primary schools for those who have no schools* • *developing vocational training programs to give skills to young people and the unemployed*	**6.19%**	**30.88%**
Q42. Establish an indigenous church planting movement within every people group on earth	**7.24%**	**27.52%**
Q45. Develop regional and global mission-field partnerships for mission agency cooperation and coordination	**5.88%**	**27.62%**
Q39. Do you believe God is calling you to set goals for your ministry?	**3.99%**	**11.13%**
Q43. Reach unreached social groups such as the youth	**3.36%**	**14.60%**
Q44. Ethnic Reconciliation	**0.42%**	**3.99%**

Table 5.1: Questions for Convictions Regarding Calling (Focus Groups)

We can note that even though participants in focus groups were forced to prioritize three items, the top three choices are almost equal when combining the results of the first three choices. The order in table 5.1 is based on ranking of first choices. The three choices of communicating the Gospel to every person, making the Scriptures available through relevant media, and seeking social transformation through holistic approaches do at the

same time seem to be three dimensions of one approach. They are integrated into each other.

Another set of four issues were also selected as fairly high priority items, "*For the church to be a prophetic voice to the city", "Establish an indigenous church planting movement within every people group on earth", "Develop regional and global mission-field partnerships for mission agency cooperation and coordination",* and "*Get the church involved in things like*

- *developing a primary health care network*
- *improving the health of communities*
- *teaching adults, and especially women, to read and write*
- *establishing primary schools for those who have no schools*
- *developing vocational training programs to give skills to young people and the un-employed"*

The remaining three issues are all important, but as the participants were asked to choose only three priority items, they were given very little response. It could be argued that the content of these questions is specific, and they have already been covered by the other questions.

It should be fairly safe to say that for the participants; these items are different aspects of the same task. It is focusing on a new, integrated, strategic, and holistic approach.

Comments on Future Priorities

Seek Social Transformation

The emphasis here is on a holistic gospel that not only transforms an individual person, but it will have transforming con- sequences for societies, for trade and economics, for law, and for human rights. It is seeking the power from God which will lead to new lives, beautiful as created in the image of God. It is in that context we find the next two choices.

The focus on social transformation achieved through holistic evangelism approaches accepts the total integration of the need for ministering to the whole human being. Evangelism among the poor cannot ignore their economic misery and their social degradation. Evangelism among people of other Faiths will often be dependent on love-expressions by the Christians. But the focus on social trans- formation will also challenge materialism and the unethical use of resources by the wealthy societies.

Personal Evangelism

The focus on individuals as Christ's ambassadors is recognition of the fact that most people are brought to faith in Jesus through the help and witness of another

on, being that a friend, a missionary, or a family member. It has something to do with "living faith", where the testimony of an individual impacts the thinking of another person. Through faithful explanation of the Gospel, it does indeed be- come *good news* for that person. By giving this issue highest ranking, the respondents do suggest that this focus should still be the calling point for the Lausanne movement in its attempt to assist local initiatives.

Making the Scriptures Available

It is not just a matter of making them available, but it is an issue of ap- plied communication of the Scriptures through appropriate channels for all people, including both readers and non- readers. In an increasingly non-reading world, it involves the production of Scripture material in relevant and appropriate forms and media. This will then combine the above two choices: the Scriptures are presented by personal involvement in the context of holistic mission.

It should be noted that availability will include use of the Scriptures. We see in many societies that printed Scriptures are available, but they are hardly used. Together with making Scripture material available there is therefore a need to greatly expand the availability of engagement material and approaches, so that people will be helped to open the Scriptures and apply the lessons to their daily lives.

Prophetic Voices
This issue did not receive a ranking among the first three, but the people of God have always been asked by God to be prophetic voices to their societies. The prophets of old were sent to kings and rulers with a word from God. In the future, the Church may be called upon to be the moral and just voice of the people during injustice, misuse of resources, ethnic cleansing, and persecution. It is the conscience of a nation, and it is to be a voice for the voiceless.

Indigenous Church Planting
It is not clear if the respondents were only focusing on church planting movements as such, or if the concern was on indigenous movements in general.

There is a growing understanding of the need for indigenous movements. We see the emergence of such movements in many parts of the world, and it is encouraging to see the results of approaches that are born from within a people group. Unfortunately, this has in some cases led to the withdrawal of sup- port from outside. The future calls for cooperation in this area, where leader- ship and frontline people may be from the indigenous group, but where financial and logistics support will be provided by brothers and sisters from other countries.

Partnerships and Cooperation
It is clear from the data that there is a strong interest in the development of partnerships, and for mission/evangelism agencies to cooperate much more in the future. It may be that there is a need for developing models of such cooperation. During the last few years, we have seen encouraging attempts at partnerships and cooperation. It is not only in the area of mission we see partnerships developing, but in business and other areas of life, people are discovering the strength of working together in a synergetic relationship. Partnership and cooperation among established churches and institutions are not easy and require extensive work and dedication, but when looking at the results, we should not have any doubts regarding the advantages.

Social Programs
The data also indicate a strong interest in the development of social programs. As we look at the world, we realize that many of the social movements, schools, hospitals, women's programs, literacy training, and other skills training have been programs started by evangelical churches and missionaries. As the Gospel penetrates new and officially closed societies, many social programs are started, and that the churches are getting high recognition for involvement in such programs. Evangelism in the context of social pro- grams will be called for increasingly in the future. Some such programs may be "forced" on churches as they are faced with an increasing number of orphans and widows due to AIDS.

Setting Goals

During the last few decades where emphasis has been on management and planning, goal setting has been an important issue. Goal setting is important, but there is today a stronger focus on *mission* as being involved with people, and then let God provide the results. The focus seems to have changed from numbers to people.

Unreached Social Groups

In earlier sections of this research, we have seen the strong focus on reaching social groups, the youth. It is evident that the churches are not reaching the youth in many countries. The youth are influenced by post-modern thinking and ask for dialogue and involvement. Often, they see the church as hierarchical and preachy with a message that does not seem relevant to their lives. For the future life of the church, it is mandatory that this challenge is taken seriously by the leadership.

Ethnic Reconciliation

Around the world we have serious ethnic conflicts, and the church is called upon to provide a message of peace and recon- ciliation. In a couple of African countries church leaders have shown the way of forgiveness, reconciliation, and grace. It is obviously not a priority item in all countries, but in countries with strife and war, it may be a very important topic that will give the church a significant voice and respect when dealing with difficult issues.

Suitable Watchword

The next set of questions in the World Inquiry sought to get the responses to a selected list of mottos for a world evangelization movement:

The basic question was:

> *What would be a suitable phrase (watchword) to capture the essence of world evangelization to serve as a unifying paradigm for the next twenty-five years?*

The respondents were given 10 suggestions among which they were asked to select the three most suitable:

1. *The Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World*
2. *Fill the World with the Glory of God/ God's Glory for All*
3. *The Power, the Presence and the Peace of God for all*
4. *City-Reaching*
5. *Social Transformation/Transforming our World*
6. *Turning the World Right Side Up/Changing Our World*
7. *Christ's Kingdom Come*
8. *The Church for Every People*
9. *The Evangelization of the World in this Generation*
10. *Discipling the Nations*

Summary of Respondents' Answers Regarding Suitable Watchword

In table 5.2 we have provided the first choice by members of Focus groups. The results from the survey give the same priority with slightly more strength to the motto regarding Discipling the Nations. Overall there is a strong support for the motto of "*The Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World*". We can note that this has been the motto used extensively in the Lausanne movement through the years.

	Focus Groups First Choice
Whole Church taking Whole Gospel to the Whole World	33.08%
Fill the World with the Glory of God	6.93%
The Power, the Presence and the Peace of God for all	8.19%
City-Reaching	3.46%
Social Transformation	3.67%
Changing our World	6.93%
Christ's Kingdom Come	6.19%
The Church for Every People	5.25%
The Evangelization of the World in this Generation	7.03%
Discipling the Nations	14.07%

Table 5.2: First Choices by Focus Groups Regarding Motto

A Specific Time Frame?

Respondents were asked if a motto or watchword should include a specific time frame of 2025. Only 0.21% of the Focus groups (combined three choices 3.25%) felt this would be very suitable. In the Survey 21.48% felt it was important.

What Global Structures Can Offer Local Christian Leaders

The next set of questions sought to obtain information on the importance of various activities, which a future global structure could provide local Christian leaders in order to enhance world evangelization efforts.

Q.	**Global Structure** (Survey results)	**Very Important**
52	Inspiration and prayer networks	72.44%
53	Serve their country/Bless their country / Nation building	32.79%
54	Leadership development	61.52%
55	Pertinent information for world evangelization	48.20%
56	Resource networks linking to resource geographical and/or functional world evangelization initiatives	41.24%
57	Functional networks linking by ministry-type	34.64%
58	Reports on what is happening in other cities/countries	37.70%
59	Relationship building with other leaders / Fellowship networking opportunities	50.67%
60	Place / opportunity for missiological reflection	40.33%
61	Networking opportunities by geographic area	38.06%
62	Place for publications on missiological issues	35.16%

Table 5.3: Activities by Global Structure (Survey Participants)

Global Structure	First choice	Comb. 3 choices
Inspiration and prayer networks	40.75%	71.95%
Serve / Bless their country / Nation building	2.83%	9.55%
Leadership development	17.43%	57.14%
Pertinent information for world evangelization	6.09%	21.11%
Resource networks linking to resource geographical and/or functional world evangelization initiatives	3.78%	24.57%
Functional networks linking by ministry-type	2.41%	15.23%
Reports on what is happening in other cities/countries	3.15%	15.54%
Relationship building with other leaders/ Fellowship networking opportunities	9.13%	44.43%
Place and opportunity for missiological reflection	1.68%	9.76%
Networking opportunities by geographic area	2.83%	11.86%
Place for publications on missiological issues	0.94%	4.72%

Table 5.4: Activities by Global Structure (Focus Group Participants)

It was seen from the quantitative survey, table 5.3, that most of these items are important, but when they must choose, there is a high similarity in their priorities, as seen in table 5.4. The issue of inspiration and prayer networks has the highest priority, followed by leadership development and relationship building.

The next most important issue is leader- ship development, and this is the same for all continents. It gets such a high importance rating by the respondents that it should result in serious initiatives. The question seems closely related to relationship building among leaders. The remaining points get low importance rating from European and Asian respondents, and they seem to be supportive issues for the most important topics. For respondents from Latin America, the rating of these issues is significantly higher than the average (apart from question 59).

Combining the Responses Regarding Future Activities by Global Structure

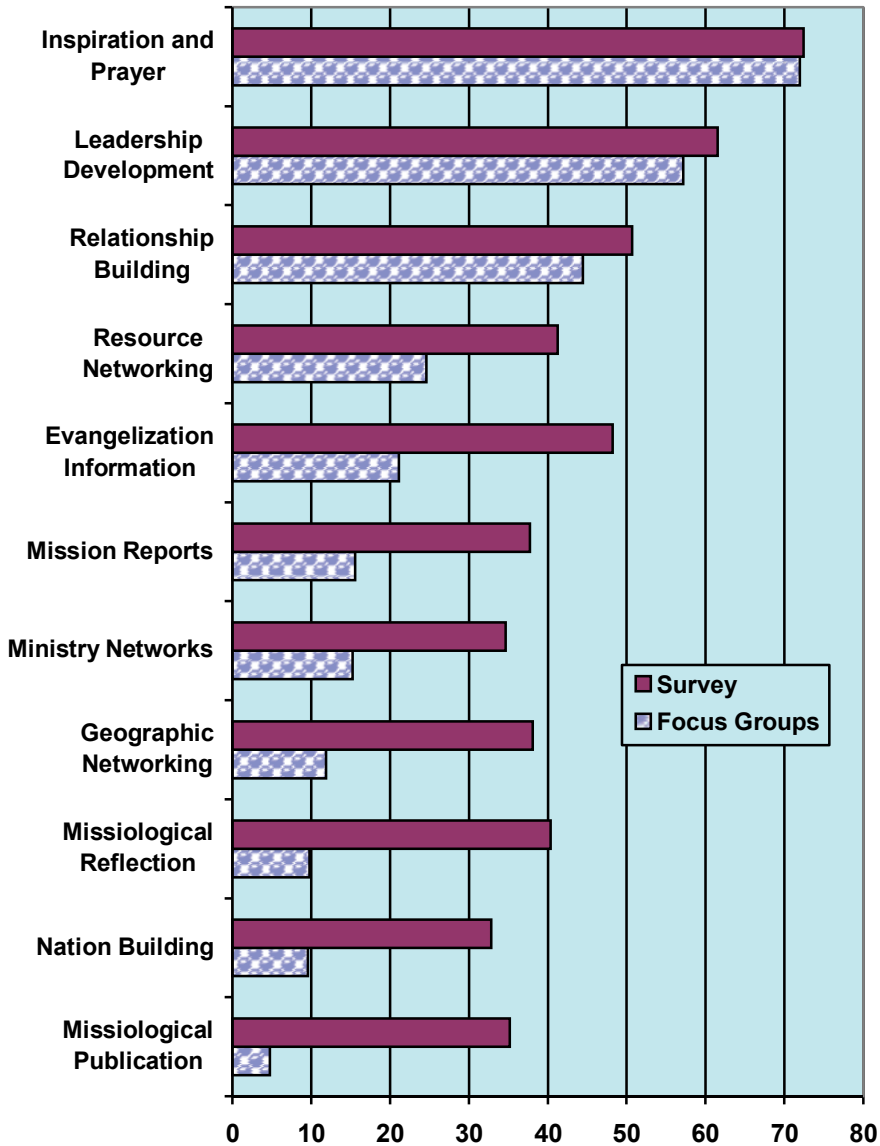


Figure 5.1: Priority of Tasks for Global Structure (Survey and Focus Groups)

Based on the responses from the total sample as presented in figure 5.1, we can give a accurate picture of what the respondents and event participants are asking for. In figure 5.1, the results are ranked according to the highest priorities given by the focus groups. This same priority order is pretty much con- firmed by the individual participants in the survey.

If the Lausanne movement or any other global structure of the future will focus its activities on the first four items, it should be possible to include all the other items as well.

Inspiration and Prayer Networks
We saw earlier that the lack of vision and prayer was the most important internal obstacle to involvement in world evangelization. By providing inspiration and encouraging prayer, the global structure will meet the highest felt need among Christian leaders. It has also been the testimony of many leaders, that this has been a major strength of the Lausanne movement in the past.

Leadership Development
Lack of good leadership was another major area of concern, and here the participants in the Inquiry events suggest that the international structure provides such training. This may be initiatives in the area of specific focus, or it could be encouraging training agencies to make relevant leadership training available to church leaders all over the world. This will, of course, need to be done on a financial level which they can afford. It will mean making leadership training available at local levels, and not just at centers in the western world.

Relationship Building
This has been a major achievement of the Lausanne movement in the past. A significant part of this was the travel and work of Senior Associates. During their visits, leaders were brought together for mutual sharing, for inspiration, and for equipping. The Lausanne conferences have also played a significant role in relationship building. It is therefore a two-sided approach with conferences on the one hand, and local events with traveling representatives on the other.

Resource Networking
This area follows naturally from the three items mentioned above. Resource net- working becomes a natural when leaders are brought together and get to know each other and the ministries they have. We have seen this happen in the past, and today we experience change and expanded ministries when leaders come together and network their resources.

If the future global structure, whether it is the Lausanne movement or another structure, will focus on these issues it will have a listening audience around the world. Chapter 6

Blazing new Trails: Obstacles Changed into Opportunities

The changing world provides challenges for creative approaches by the church engaged in evangelism. During the last three years, the World Inquiry has sought to listen to what church leaders are feeling and saying regarding world evangelization in the coming decades. There was a special focus on key leaders from areas in Africa, Latin America and Asia where the church is growing. The Inquiry was a consultative process with these leaders and the aim was to gather information that will help construct a frame- work for empowering the global church to participate in God's mission in the twenty-first century.

Reviewing the Data

According to participants, the external challenges facing the church in evangelism vary between emerging and developed countries. The responses of leaders from Africa, Asia, and Latin America show the significant challenge that religious fundamentalism is in their contexts. At the same time, churches seem unprepared for apologetic dialogue, and for new strategies based on love, respect, trust, and service. In many places materialism is taking the focus away from the common good and as a result selfish concerns for the things of this world take the attention away from spiritual issues. The relevance of the Christian faith and post-modernism are perceived to be major challenges in pretty much all countries, as Christians are not prepared or trained for evangelism in situations where you have proactive advances by non-Christian groups. The churches are also faced with the issue of a non- reading world that cannot read or do not want to read our material, and the church is not well prepared to respond in relevant media and with appropriate approaches.

The overwhelming response we see from the research regarding internal obstacles to the Church worldwide is the lack of vision, the need for inspiration and united prayer, and the shortage of effective leadership to inspire God's people to carry out a God-given vision. It looks like a tired leadership that needs new energy and new challenges. Christian leaders across the spectrum ex- pressed a great need for fellowship and relationship building. But their openness to use appropriate approaches indicates a desire to see things change. There was also a new concern for the communication of the Biblical message through all means available, so the data does

seem to indicate a commitment to change, but a lack of know-how and self- esteem.

Participants across the board viewed reaching unreached social groupings as a great challenge, and the focus seemed to be primarily on the youth. The concern expressed was strong and is in many places an issue of utmost urgency.

The issue of social transformation, or mission as transformation received high priority. Social transformation was de- fined as seeking positive change in the whole of human life, materially, socially and spiritually. By recovering our identity as human beings created in the image of God, we discover our true vocation as productive stewards, faithfully caring for our world and its people. The western dichotomy between evangelism and social responsibility is being challenged by leaders from other parts of the world, and a new understanding is emerging, an understanding that deals with the whole life of human beings.

The data clearly indicate a call for personal evangelism and the need to proclaim the Gospel to every person. The research also suggests that evangelism and social transformation need to be kept together in response to God's calling. It is a matter of "The Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World". The overwhelming choice of this phrase ap- pears to be reflecting the importance of a vision that appeals to a balanced approach to world evangelization, an approach that integrates the spiritual and the social implications of the gospel. It is not a question of priority, but a question of an integrated understanding of what transformational mission is. For this to happen, the participants also high- lighted the need for making the Word of God available to all people through relevant media, prepared for a non-linear thinking and non-reading population.

The combined response of all participants suggests that God is calling the church to be a prophetic voice and to make his message available in every language for both literate and for non-reading people available, that is radio, TV, film, CD, as well as printed texts.

Obstacles or Opportunities?

What has been highlighted as obstacles or problems are indicators of a changing world where traditional approaches do not fit. For those concerned with reaching this present and future world, the challenge is, as in all strategic communication, to adapt approaches to meet the need. But change is always painful, and it is seemingly especially painful for churches. As the world changes and the context in which the church finds itself changes, then it is mandatory that the church adapts to this changing situation.

Highlighting problems helps us define the needs. For the Lausanne movement, this is extremely helpful, as it helps us understand the needs of the constituency. A relevant and strategic response is then possible.

It is basically a question of communication. Communication is at the core of mission and evangelism. We have a communicating God who asks us to be communicators of *good news*. We have been handicapped as we have interpreted *good news* from a sender-oriented perspective, but it takes on new and exciting dimensions when we learn to understand that *good news* must be seen from a receptor-oriented position. Jesus is the outstanding example of such communication, and in John 20:21 we read that Jesus commissioned the disciples to continue his mission with the words, "As the Father has sent me, so I send you." The basic result of Jesus' communication was the creation of true peace and harmonious relationships, so that the message of God was understood as *good news* for the common man and woman. Today, this means living among the people, ministering through their own culturally appropriate media and approaches, and in that process bringing a holistic message of hope in Jesus Christ.

In a fellowship like the Lausanne movement we seek to inspire and equip people for effective communication in a rap- idly changing world. Unfortunately, we often tend to dwell on the past, but the future must be part of our present. We therefore look at global trends to understand the issues that are creating the reality in which we need to function in the future, and for which we need to prepare today.

Let us hope that the 31 issue groups at the Lausanne Forum will be like the leaders of Issachar and understand the times and know what the Church needs to do. We need mission leaders who can interpret global trends so that we can train and empower people who will minister effectively five or ten years from now. The Inquiry data can provide input and principles for every group, as these principles need to permeate discussion in all the groups, as each group deals with different aspects of the same task. The issue groups will be turning the obstacles into opportunities. The data from the World Inquiry does not provide much input regarding actual methods and approaches.

Religious fundamentalism can of course be a problem, but it can also provide exciting opportunities. On the one hand, the extremists have left large segments of the population open to con- sider other spiritual alternatives, and even many of the fundamentalists are open to dialogue and debate. The issue is also challenging Christians to get back into the Scriptures, and to be ready to witness. All of this gives new opportunities for Bible teaching and new advances in evangelism.

Similarly, pluralism has challenged many old churches, but it has also given cause to focus on the uniqueness of Christ. It has led people to study the Scriptures, and to be stronger in their devotions. Christians have been challenged to review their understanding of their faith and to apply this to their daily lives. This in turn provides basis for evangelism.

Materialism be a real obstacle, but it can also be a reason for new challenges. It may mean new resources available, but it can also be a challenge as David felt when he was "living in a palace of cedar, while the ark of God remains in a tent" (2. Sam. 7:2). The person taken up by materialism can be moved to extend such feelings to "the house of God."

The issue of literacy is a real obstacle to many present approaches, but the non- reading world can also call us back to learning from Jesus who was a master communicator. He told stories that were relevant to the lives of the largely non- literate audience. People remembered the stories, told them again and again, and the Gospel spread across the world. As we learn from such approaches, we are probably also learning to communicate in a post-modern area. We learn how to communicate so that people understand, remember, and apply.

Our traditional print-orientation is challenged by this and by modern technology. But that same technology gives us enormous new opportunities as we can reach into closed homes and countries with *good news* and Christian teaching to new and struggling churches. For the Christian with vision and commitment, the technology provides exciting new opportunities, but we do, of course, need to learn the skills to use such technology.

The global changes regarding illiteracy and media have greatly influenced Bible reading. Few people seem to read the Bible, and few people pay attention to Bible reading in church. Few people understand the Bible reading in church. New technology makes it possible to listen in cars, in homes, and in groups in villages. The use of Power- Point in churches has made Scriptures more central to sermons as everybody focus on the same text. The Bible has become a reality for many who did not have access before.

The impact of the alphabet created a linear way of dealing with the world, but as we move from the familiar, linear world into a world with non-linear thinking, almost everything we do in church and mission is challenged.

We are challenged by video, and here our attention is primarily on the so-called post-literate or post-modern young people who are brought up on music television. The research highlighted a major concern for reaching the youth, and when doing so media will be playing a major role. It will have to be united with personal approaches as post-modern youth look for interactive approaches where they be- come part of the process.

The so-called obstacles can also assist us in changing our focus into a more biblical perspective. The world in which we are called to communicate the love of Jesus is a poverty-stricken world. In the Gospels it seems quite clear that the poor had a special place in the heart of Jesus, and they were given priority. Among the poor, it is not always the activities we call evangelism that have most effect, but there is response when we meet them in a service for the whole person. As mentioned in chapter one, we found a road building project in an African country having significant influence on church growth. It was a project that was relating to the felt needs of people who had been suffering from civil war, but we also found simple people who had experienced new life in Christ and they just witnessed to that new life.

One of my greatest encouragements is when I meet in the jungle and mountains on the Thai-Burma border with leaders of ethnic groups who are brutally persecuted, and then help them get their message out to the world through press releases and radio programs. It is some- thing about giving voice to the voiceless.

How do we integrate these communication challenges in our teaching at theological and missiological institutions? Obviously, it is not just a matter of class- room education, but a life-long education where we will continue as mentors when our graduates are amid the demands around them.

In chapter one, four key questions were presented. These questions pretty much sum up the approach we need for effective communication: Who is my listener? Where is my listener? What are the needs of my listener? How can I meet the needs of my listener?

As we seek to answer these questions, there are other key words that will come up again and again. These are words like cooperation and partnership, holistic approaches, transformation of lives and society, and the use of non-print-based approaches. This will require new orientation and training, as we seek to be effective communicators of *good news* in the days and years ahead.

Trail Blazers: Pioneering Approaches for Our Time

As we look at churches and Christian missions around the world, we do find exciting projects and programs that have accepted the challenges and developed models for effective ministry. There is, though, a real need for new carefully researched and well documented pilot programs that can provide models for others. It would be very interesting if all the Issue Groups at the Lausanne Forum would inspire or take initiative to such experimental or pilot programs.

Case-study: Berço da Vida - Cradle of Life

Imagine an audio recording that can make children excited about learning, inspire them for creative activities, cause debate and reflections in the town council, be used in Catholic liturgy, inspire mothers to discuss family issues, and get teenage girls to dance samba. That would seem impossible, but that is exactly what is happening in Brazil through Berço da Vida, a true holistic project between the Bible Society and World Vision.

It all started at the United Bible Societies World Assembly at Midrand, South Africa, in 2000. The Assembly motto was, "God's Word, Light for the World", and there was serious work done on how to adapt the work of Bible Societies to the needs of the present world. Focus was on issues such as one half of the population is functionally non-literate...classified as 'absolutely poor'; and millions are subject to the pressures of religious fundamentalism. Up to this time, Bible Societies have had difficulties in reaching the non-literate, as most distribution strategies do not reach the poor of this world. Often the non-literates are also the poor.



It was therefore encouraging when Assembly delegates from all over the world made significant commitments. They decided that: *in order to advance and enhance our common task, we commit ourselves over the next four years to:*

- Create new tools and products that encourage people to read or otherwise encounter Scripture with special attention to groups concerned with specific issues (such as youth, family and poverty) and situations (such as AIDS and natural disasters) and available in all formats, including new non-print media.
- Create new products that encourage people to understand and engage personally with Scripture.
- Look for ways in which we can work with others in holistic programs, serving the whole person, recognizing our unique contribution of bringing the Word of Life and Hope to people in need.
- Develop appropriate biblical materials for non-literate people and new readers.

These decisions were very much in line with the proposals now coming out of the World Inquiry. In summary we can note that there was a commitment to:

- reach audiences not earlier reached – including the huge number of poor people.
- engage in holistic projects and programs that deal with people's real needs and do so in strategic alliances with churches and organizations.
- develop appropriate distribution systems that assure the availability of the Scriptures to the poor of this world.
- use new media and methods as less than half the world's population are readers.
- work in partnerships, both with other Bible Societies and with other agencies.

Berço da Vida, a Bible Society – World Vision project, meets all these criteria in a creative way. The two sponsoring agencies are ideal partners as they complement each other in unique ways. The United Bible Societies with 139 National Bible Societies around the world have the production skills. World Vision Inter- national has the local network among the poor. It is the world's largest humanitarian organization, and on a world basis, World Vision has 1.8 million sponsored children. It is an organization built on evangelical foundations, and they want true transformation in the lives of children and poor people, including a desire to give them an opportunity to interact with the Bible message. A partnership be- tween a Bible Society and World Vision would therefore seem most appropriate.

Partnership: It was agreed that the project would be developed in partner- ship, and the material would consist of both audio and printed material, all presented in a nice package which could be given as a gift to sponsored families. The distribution system would be integrated into the system of regular meetings which was already taking place with sponsored families. It was tentatively agreed that the set of material would contain:

- Audio dramas that would deal with family issues, the rights of children, and healthy and happy families.
- There would be biblical material in audio, either a gospel with the Life of Jesus, or a selection of texts.
- The material would include songs that focus on the same issues, so that the content would be memorized. The music would be locally produced and follow traditional music styles.
- There would also be audio material that deals with Christian holidays, either Christmas or Easter to give a basic background to the faith.
- The material would include a printed booklet with concerns of World Vision, song texts, and activity material for children.
- An appropriate Scripture selection for children and families would also be included, and there would be a competition or game that would lead to further engagement.

Pilot program: It was decided to con- duct two pilot projects. These would be done in Brazil and Mexico, as it was felt that the National Bible Societies in these countries had the necessary capacity for production, and World Vision had strong and effective management.

A workshop was conducted in Recife, Brazil in October 2001 for selected participants from both the Bible Society and from World Vision. We worked for three days on issues, content and outlines. It was decided to launch the project under the name of *Berço da Vida* which means "Cradle of Life". The Bible Society of Brazil would act as the production company and prepare the material in close cooperation with World Vision. The aim was to have a professional production, but at low cost due to the need of the audience. The Bible Society was able to secure donated time from drama and song writers, as well as from singers and musicians. Outstanding material was therefore produced at a reasonable cost.

Pretesting: The initial production was tested extensively in two locations in Brazil, and it was very exciting to review the progress and to see how the material was used. There was much enthusiasm and excitement, and it was clear that the material was meeting a real need, and it had lived up to the purpose established a year earlier in Recifé.

One test area was the Cactus Area Development Project (ADP) in the very poor and semi-arid region of the Province of Alagoas, north-eastern Brazil. The whole Province of Alagoas has 70% illiteracy. The other site was in the slums of Rio de Janeiro with the primary focus on the St. James Catholic Parish. Several copies of the material were made available for pretesting.

The visit to the Cactus project was very encouraging. Both the regional World Vision staff and the local project staff had done an excellent job of testing the material. All project staff members in the area are Catholics. World Vision is having an extensive ministry in this extremely poor area, and there are 1680 sponsored children from a total of 560 homes. The staff expressed much appreciation for the material, including the fact that people want to discuss social problems from a spiritual perspective, and this material helped them do this. They had organized two children groups of app. 40 children, and two teenage groups, and they had facilitated activities where the children creatively interacted with the material through drawings. The children had learned the songs by heart. One 6- year old girl proudly showed that she could write a sentence in response to a question, but she could not write prior to this project. They found it more difficult to get teenagers involved in creative interaction, but when we visited a teen-age group the girls danced samba to the music, and they knew the songs by heart.

The material was also used in schools, and at the local Catholic church they used the material in liturgy and services, as well as in catechist classes. Village leaders had also listened. Everybody was looking forward to getting seats for each family. It was also suggested that a set should be sent to each school in the area and to each priest, so that they could get people to listen and work with the material. They wanted much more and had many suggestions for further material. One of the WV staff commented, "We have always been dependent on material produced for use in churches. This material is contextualized to our situation."

The situation in Rio was quite different. At the Catholic church we participated in a session with mothers of sponsored children. The session was skillfully led by two ladies from the church, one a psychologist who works with the families, and the other a retired school teacher. The whole topic dealt with issues related to family life as one of the recorded dramas focused on the rights of children. This was followed by lively discussion on how the rights of children could be assured in their families. Then the women worked in groups and produced posters on the topic by cutting and gluing pictures from magazines. It was well done and with much enthusiasm. Later we visited the slum where the ministry from the church takes place. The women expressed enthusiasm regarding the material, and they wanted to take the CDs home to play for husbands and neighbors. They only come home from work in the evenings, so listening times would have to be after 8.00 pm.

Issues for improvement: Following actual field testing, the results were re- viewed for final editing and production. The material had been very well received. The songs were good and the stories well written, easy to understand, relevant to the context, and engaging the listeners. There was a desire for more stories that would relate more directly to the parents of the sponsored children. It was decided to include a drama on violence in the family in the final set of material.

Originally, we anticipated using audio cassettes, but it was found that hardly anyone in Brazil use audio cassettes. CDs have taken over, so all audio material would be produced on CD. At least half the families have CD players, and others can listen on sets owned by neighbors. It was felt that for those who do not have players, there should be listening centers. Listening centers can be set up at schools and churches, so each school and each priest should have a copy.

There were several other suggestions regarding the printed material, as this was obviously the most difficult material among people who read very little. It was decided to include a brief manual as well as an evaluation form.

It was originally planned that each sponsored child would get a set, but as there is an average of 3 – 4 sponsored children in each family, only one set should be distributed to a family. For example, in the group in Rio there was one 29-year old mother with 8 children. During the test period, it was also learned that the material can be excellent bridges for staff and church workers when dealing with poor families. There were also many other creative uses such as one lady using the material among street children, and priests were using it in their catechist classes.

Production and Distribution: The Brazilian Bible Society finalized the production and a total of 20,000 sets were produced. World Vision then distributed the material through their regional offices.



World Vision decided that the project and the material could be used to revitalize their volunteer program, so an extensive training program was launched. Representatives from each region were given training, and they would in turn train local people in the use of *Berço da Vida* material. This has proved to be a very exciting and excellent program.

Just take the example of the Amazons. The local World Vision office conducted a two-day training program for 25 local facilitators. This was done professionally with participation of a lawyer that could discuss issues treated on the CDs, and a choreographer gave instructions on how the material could be performed by children. There were extensive discussions on how to use the material. The participants were trained through role plays where they practiced presentations in the various communities in the Amazon area. One group used puppets, another street drama, and so on. Then there was de- tailed planning for each community in this vast and remote area. The estimate was that each set would reach 315 people, so the 500 sets received for the Amazon region would reach over 15,000 people.

The "system" had to be adapted to the Amazon area, as the communities are very poor and most do not have CDs. Often there is no electricity. The project is therefore working very much on a group concept with a facilitator. Church- es are involved as centers for listening and discussion, and schools and teachers get training in the use.

One of the partners is the Presbyterian Church that works among communities along the river and its tributaries. The small local churches are challenged, and school teachers help children to work with the material. In one location they have even developed a drama group of children that travel/sail from community to community performing biblical dramas which they have learned from the CDs. Here *Berço da Vida* is almost taking on its own identify as a program.

On the outskirts of Manaus one of the partners is a Catholic church, where the program is led by an enthusiastic and dedicated young lady. The children come from very poor homes, and most of them have only one parent, usually a single mother. The children are taught the dramas, families are gathered for events, and the program even sponsors *Berço da Vida* Mother's Day. The same material is proving to be useful for a wide variety of situations, and fits well into the work of different denominations, Catholic, Baptist, Presbyterian, Pentecostal, and many others.

In another project operated by a Methodist Church in a slum area in the city of Manaus, children and young people, as well as their families are reached, and again it is the *Berço da Vida* material that functions as a bridge to the families. Within that context serious family and spiritual issues are handled, and people come into fellowship with God through Jesus Christ. There is even a small choir that sings *Berço da Vida* songs.

Comments and Observations:

As we reflect on the *Berço da Vida* case- study, the project is a very positive experience. There have been many challenges and delays have occurred, but we should be ready

for this in a new pilot project which includes many new dimensions of partnership, ways of production, preparation of the scripts, new ways of distribution, etc. A lot has been learned and new doors have been opened. The influence of an outside person/consultant was indispensable in the development of such a project. The project has started a relationship with good potential for the future, and the actual project can be a model for working with others. For the Bible Society, it has been a chance to follow the mandate of the World Assembly. Similar projects could possibly be developed with many other organizations. It is a matter of bringing our re- sources together and each one doing what we are best at. The project is a success because the Bible Society produced relevant and excellent material, but it is equally due to the fact that World Vision gave its full commitment and developed an excellent training and distribution/use program.

Some of the great lessons from the program are:

- ✓ The target group consists of very poor people that have traditionally not been reached. It is estimated that up to three million people will be touched by the program.
- ✓ The project is holistic, integrating true development dimensions.
- ✓ The distribution system assures that all can have access to the material, as it utilizes a network already in existence.
- ✓ The training program developed by World Vision had a significant input to the success of the pro- gram.
- ✓ The use of cassette tapes or CDs makes it possible for all to listen.
- ✓ The work is done in partnership with an organization that already has the contacts and the distribution possibilities. Most of the people in South America are Catholics, so the work is conducted on a true ecumenical basis.
- ✓ The project is true partnership and a good application of the mission statements of both World Vision International and the United Bible Societies.

Other promising projects

As we look around the world, we do find many other examples of churches or mission agencies that are "blazing trails" for the future. In India and surrounding countries, Gospel for Asia and other agencies are finding that local missionaries can be recruited in the thousands, and new churches are established all over the South Asian area. They are also finding local supporting constituencies. We see extensive use of media, as well as involvement in social services in the communities where they minister.

The Thai Faith and Music Foundation is showing the way for effective ministry in the slums of Bangkok. They make ex- tensive use of Thai cultural forms such as dance, music, and drama. In this way they get the young people off the streets and involved in healthy activities. Within a few years, they have seen churches established in the slums, and hundreds of children are learning about Jesus. In neighboring Laos the number of Chris- tians is growing significantly in spite of hindrances by the communist government. People listen to Bible teaching on the radio, and they meet in small groups. In 1990 there were only a few dozen Christians in the capitol city of Vientiane, but today there are 26 congregations in the area. For God there is no closed doors, and for Christians with a commitment to bring *good news* to others, there are always opportunities.

The Consortium for Indian Missiological Education is a partnership among theological seminaries. Here evangelical seminaries work together to provide a doctoral program in mission studies so that they will be able to provide excellent training programs for missionaries.

The Voice of Peace Christian Communication Center in Chiang Mai works with all Christian churches, assisting them with training and the production of high

quality radio and television programs for Thai broadcasting stations. No church can do this alone, but through such a program they can all participate and make use of media programs especially made for their situation.

In Mexico the Bible Society and World Vision works on a program like that in Brazil. With the huge slums in Mexico City and with a large segment of the population being very poor, such a partnership can give hope to many, as the Word of God is communicated to the poor in relevant and effective ways.

The Forum of Bible Societies with seven- teen major international Bible agencies involved has proved that cooperation between agencies is possible when a dedicated effort is made. The Forum has sponsored experimental and test pro- grams in Ghana where several different local agencies and churches are involved

in helping each other find new ways of reaching people with the Scriptures. Special radio programs have opened doors among a largely Muslim audience.

The Faith Comes By Hearing program is gathering Christians in groups to listen to the Scriptures on tape and discuss its meaning. Similarly, programs like the Talking Bible are gathering non-believers for listening sessions, and many are accepting Christ as a result.

In Bangladesh a media-based and Scripture focused literacy program is teaching many to read and write, and at the same time teaching them about God and his concern for all of us.

Many other examples could be given, but the above stories are selected to encourage us in the task of evangelism. Even though we may have huge challenges, it can be done.

Consulting the Word

The main purpose of the Inquiry was to consult Christian leaders from many different countries. As a conclusion to this report, we do also want to present a few "research results" from the Word of God.

As Christian communicators and evangelists, we are entering the ministry which has been God's concern through the ages: revealing himself to humanity. The commission to communicate permeates all aspects of Christian ministry, and it is the motivational force for commitment and dedication. It is "communication for a purpose,"

God is by nature a communicator. He "expressed" himself at the time of creation. He spoke, and things happened. He sought company with Adam, Abraham, Moses, and David. He let his Son live in a social context, and he leads his people into a mew, warm community of believers. When looking at the way in which he communicates, we can learn significant lessons about effective Chris- tian ministry.

The incarnation of Jesus sets the stage for perfect communication between God and us. It is the climax of God's communication with us. As one translation puts it, "The Son is the radiance of God's glory and the exact representation of his being" (Heb. 1:3) and "the image of the invisible God" (Col. 1:15). When the disciples wanted to see the Father, Jesus said, in effect, "Look at me" (John 14:8ff). Jesus spoke the words the Father sent him to speak (John 3:34), and he carried out the work of the Father (John 10:37- 38). The lesson for the Christian communicator is to be completely identified with the message preached.[14]

When we look at God's incarnation, we are looking at the center of communication[15] and the essential essence of communication theory. By this action God was bending down to disclose himself through ordinary situations of human life, thus becoming completely relevant to the context of human beings. He did it at a time in history and through one

[14] Charles Kraft, *Communication Theory for Christian Witness.* Rev. ed. Maryknoll: Orbis Books. 1991:17.

[15] Knud Jørgensen, "The Role and Function of the Media in the Mission of the Church" 1981:27. Unpublished Ph.D. dissertation presented to Fuller Theological Seminary, School of World Mission, Pasadena.

culture. By studying this incarnational communication of God, we will not refute human communication, but discover the key that can redeem or re- store the human communication process.

The incarnation is then the ideal model of communication. It is the crowning event in which all other forms of God's communication with humanity are embodied.[16] Communication through incarnation is being involved in a context, entering the real problems, issues, and struggles of the people. Jesus did not just speak to the Jews, but he became a Jew and identified himself with all aspects of Jewish life. He identified with the social outcasts and participated in the social relationships of the Jewish culture. He became a true human being, even working as a carpenter. He spoke to their needs, rather than presenting a message of universal abstracts.

Through this example of Christ, we are challenged to go beyond mere oral proclamation and to re-enact or represent the Word in fullness to the world. This calls for new interpretations, and new actions as the Word permeates new cultures. The church has not always understood the implications and responsibilities inherent in this commission and has often failed to communicate the message to others. The pulpit in one of the cathedrals in Denmark has inscribed in Latin— and with Gothic characters—the quote from Luke 11:28, "Blessed are those who hear the Word of God and keep it." The Latin word, which we translate "keep," is "custodiunt." This leads our thoughts to the word "custodian," a person who looks after artifacts in a museum or other buildings. The church has often treated the Word of God that way: kept it for our- selves. In the biblical understanding we "keep" the living Word of God by communicating it to others.

We do always need to remember that Christian ministry is a spiritual work, and ultimately all results will depend on the Holy Spirit. In the task of proclaiming the Gospel, the Spirit utilizes the church as his agent, but the task of bringing a per- son from darkness into the light of Christ is the exclusive role of the Holy Spirit (John 6:44; Titus 3:5-7). The communicator is a witness and a channel, not the power. It is the Spirit who truly controls the whole process of Gospel communication and evangelism. We are told in 1 Corinthians 2:1-16 that the Spirit enables us to "know," "speak," "interpret," and "judge" or "appraise" spiritual truths. Thus, the constant power source is the Holy Spirit. The "communication link" is prayer (Eph. 6:18-20). The implication for the Chris- tian communicator is to commit himself or herself through prayer to the guidance of the Spirit and then anticipate the mighty work of the Spirit in conviction and healing and in the creation of true wholeness.

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[16] Robert E. Webber, *God Still Speaks. A Biblical View of Christian Communication.* Nashville: Thomas Nelson Publishers. 1980:97.

This involvement by the Spirit is not a "cooperative effort" by God and human beings, as if there are areas and capacities of our lives outside his control. It is not a question of God and me each making a contribution, but rather, it is a question of the indwelling Christ working through his body, the Church, and its individual members. It is an incarnational concept, Christ in us working through us (Col. 1:27). It is not us "using" the Spirit, but it is the Spirit using us. Christ is not only using us and speaking through us as his ambassadors (2 Cor. 5:20), but he is also working through the mental capacities he has given us to develop plans and carry out evangelism activities. In the language of communication, Christ is encoded in our lives, making it essential that we, the communicators, are part of the message we proclaim.

We do want to look at effectiveness and results of our ministry, but we also need to recognize that there are issues we may not understand. For God, effective- ness will probably be seen from the perspective of eternity. He is concerned about shalom, the presence of the kingdom of God. We find that all God's revelation and redemptive work is directed towards establishing this goal of harmonious relationships. God seems more concerned with obedience and faithful- ness than with mere "evangelistic results." It is also helpful to look at effectiveness from the perspective of the listener or receptor. We will then be judged in relation to how he or she experiences needs met, and how a new joy and fullness of life in fellowship with God and with other human beings is experienced. May such an experience be a reality for millions of people around the world.

Appendix

QUANTITATIVE SURVEY QUESTIONNAIRE ANSWERED INDIVIDUALLY

Question I. 1-16. **What are the major <u>external</u> challenges facing the Church regarding evangelization in our city or country?**

* Please check the box you which think best indicates the degree of importance where **1** is the most important and **5** is the least important.		1 Most important	2	3	4	5 Least important
1	Globalization—the internationalizing of our shrinking world due to rapid communication toward a common culture					
2	Racial Tension					
3	Pluralism—the coexistence within the one political community of groups who hold incompatible views regarding religion					
4	Illiteracy					
5	Post-modernity—exhaustion of modernity. It celebrates diversity, fragmentation, ambivalence					
6	Religious fundamentalism					
7	*Injustice caused by persecution or political opposition*					
8	*Technological advances*					
9	Unreached linguistic and ethno-cultural peoples					
10	Unreached geographic areas					
11	Unreached social groupings - such as the youth					
12	AIDS and other major diseases					
13	Materialism/Distraction					
14	Relevance of the Christian Faith					
15	Food and Water					
16	Other—please specify					

		1	2	3	4	5
II. Question II. 17-30. What are the major obstacles internal to the Church to participate effectively in world evangelization (beyond the city)?		**A big problem**				**Not a problem**
17	Lack of money					
18	Lack of effective leadership					
19	Lack of vision and understanding (i.e. burden)					
20	Lack of workers					
21	Lack of training of workers					
22	Lack of appreciation by outsiders of contextualized local distinctives					
23	Opposition from inside the church					
24	Family issues					
25	Lack of inspiration and united prayer					
26	Lack of good research and information on the remaining task					
27	Lack of effective cooperation & coordinated action between mission agencies					
28	Lack of common goals or strategies for world evangelization					
29	Unhealthy churches that are not able to reproduce themselves					
30	Other. Please specify					

		1	2	3	4	5
Question III. 31-40. What do you believe God is calling His people to do in evangelization over the next 25 years?		**Very much**				**Not really**
31	*Preach the gospel to every person using personal evangelism*					

32	*Make the Scriptures and gospel message available in every language for both literate and non-reading by radio, TV, the Jesus Film, Bible translation and distribution and by CD*					
33	Do you believe God is calling you to set goals for your ministry?					
34	Seek social transformation—seeking positive change in the whole of human life materially, socially and spiritually, by recovering our true identity as human beings created in the image of God and discovering our true vocation as productive stewards, faithfully caring for our world and people.					
35	For the church to be a prophetic voice to the city					
36	Establish an indigenous church planting movement within every people group on earth					
37	Reach unreached social groups such as the youth					
38	Ethnic Reconciliation					
39	Develop regional and global mission-field partnerships for mission agency cooperation and coordination					
40	(Mark only one for the entire question) Get the church involved in things like: • developing a primary health care network • improving the health of communities • teaching adults, and especially women, to read and write • establishing primary schools for those who have no schools • developing vocational training programs to give skills to young people and the unemployed	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**

		1	2	3	4	5
Question IV. 41-51. What would be a suitable phrase (watchword) to capture the essence of world evangelization to serve as a unifying paradigm for the next 25 years? 1 is very suitable 5 is not suitable						
41	The Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World					
42	Fill the World with the Glory of God/ God's Glory for All					
43	The Power, the Presence and the Peace of God for all					
44	City-reaching					
45	Social Transformation/ Transforming our World					
46	Turning the World Right Side Up/ Changing Our World					
47	Christ's Kingdom Come					

48	The Church for Every People					
49	The Evangelization of the World in This Generation					
50	Discipling the nations					
51	Should the watchword have the time frame of 2025?					

Question V. 52-62. How important are the following for Global Evangelical Structures to provide to local Christian leaders to enhance world evangelization efforts?		**1** Very much	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5** Not much
52	Inspiration & prayer networks					
53	Serve their country/Bless their country/Nation building					
54	Leadership development					
55	Pertinent information for world evangelization					
56	Resource networks linking to resource geographical and/or functional world evangelization initiatives					
57	Functional networks linking by ministry-type					
58	Reports on what is happening in other cities/countries					
59	Relationship building with other leaders/Fellowship networking opportunities					
60	Place and opportunity for missiological reflection					
61	Networking opportunities by geographic area					
62	Place for publications on missiological issues					

Question VI. 63-79. You decided to trust (place your faith in) Jesus Christ as your Savior because of?		**1** Very important	**2** Import-ant	**3** More or less importa nt	**4** Not so important	**5** Not at all important
63	Witness of your parents					
64	Witness by other family member, friend or other person					
65	Invitation to receive Christ at a crusade event or special evangelistic meeting					
66	Reading the Bible					
67	Invitation to place your faith in Christ at a local church					
68	Listening to audiotapes					

69	Reading Christian literature or a book					
70	Prayers on your behalf by family member or friend					
71	Dream or vision like Paul on Damascus road					
72	Responding to an evangelistic message on television					
73	Listening to radio					
74	The invitation given at a Jesus Film showing					
75	Film (other than Jesus Film)					
76	Invitation at a retreat or conference					
77	Miracle of healing or other kind of miracle					
78	Gradual growing conviction					
79	Other					

Question VII. 80. Which man and woman best fits the following criteria in your city?

- Evidences Christ-likeness in character.
- Healthy family relationships in the Christian family.
- Embodies the Spirit of Lausanne (". . . new and urgent commitment to world evangelization in all its aspects, a new attitude of cooperation in that task, and a new cultural sensitivity to the world to which we were called" with integrity).
- Between thirty and forty-five years old at July 30, 2004.
- Spiritual authority - that anointing of God, which comes through gifted power, deep shaping experiences with God, and a godly character.
- Flexibility - adjusts to meet new opportunities.
- Learning Posture - overcomes the tendency to plateau. Daniel set an example as we find him still studying the Bible in his old age: Daniel 9.
- Demonstrates personal vibrant relationship with God and others.
- The whole Body – while keeping doctrinal distinctives embraces the entire body of Christ in word and deed.
- Scope of influence - recognized by those of different groups within the city/country as a Christian leader who has exercised positive, persistent, specific influence for Christ within that city/nation/region.

Name of Man: _____ Name of Woman: _____

Question VIII. 81-99. What is your contact information?

81. Family name ..... 82. Given name_____

83. Title_____

84. Organization _____

85. Address _____

86. City _____

87. State/Province _____

88. Zip/Postal Code _____

89. Country_____

90. Phone _____

91. E-mail _____

92. Gender: (1) Male_____ (2) Female _____

93. Age: (1) Below 25_____(2) 25 – 35 _____ (3) 36 – 50 _____
(4) 51 – 65_____(5) Above 65 _____

94. Age trusted Christ as Savior: (1) Under 14_____ (2) 15 – 29 _____
(3) 30 – 50_____(4) Above 51_____(5) Do not know _____

95. Did either of your parents believe in Jesus Christ as their Savior?
(1) Mother only_____(2) Father only_____(3) Both mother and father_____

96. How would identify yourself with regard to your ministry?
(1) Pastor____(2) Mission leader____(3) Bible School or Seminary leader_____
(4) Teacher____(5) Lay leader____(6) Youth leader____(7) Worship leader _____
(8) Prayer Leader/Intercessor _____

97. Would you like to be informed on the results of the global survey?
(1) Yes____(2) No ____

98. In what other language_____

99. Would you like to be associated with a global evangelization movement?
(1) Yes____(2) No_____ (3) Maybe _____

QUALITATIVE SURVEY ANSWERED BY FOCUS GROUPS

Question I. 2-18. (Omit Question 1) What are the major external challenges facing the Church regarding evangelization in our city or country?

	Select 3 only & rank from the highest=1, 2=second highest, 3=third highest	**1=highest**
2	Globalization—the internationalizing of our shrinking world due to rapid communication toward a common culture	
3	Racial Tension	
4	Pluralism—the coexistence within the one political community of groups who hold incompatible views regarding religion	
5	Illiteracy	
6	Post-modernity—exhaustion of modernity. It celebrates diversity, fragmentation, ambivalence	
7	Religious fundamentalism	
8	Persecution/Political opposition/Injustice	
9	Technological advances	
10	Unreached linguistic and ethno-cultural peoples	
11	Unreached geographic areas	
12	Unreached social groupings - such as the youth	
13	AIDS and other major diseases	
14	Materialism/Distraction	
15	Relevance of the Christian Faith	
16	Food and Water	
17	Other. Please specify	

Question II. 22-36. (Omit Questions 18-21) What are the major obstacles internal to the Church to participate effectively in world evangelization (beyond the city)?

	Select 3 only & rank from the highest=1, 2=second highest, 3=third highest	1=highest
22	Lack of money	
23	Lack of effective leadership	
24	Lack of vision	
25	Lack of workers	
26	Lack of training of workers	
27	Lack of appreciation by outsiders of contextualized local distinctives	
28	Opposition from inside the church	

29	Family issues	
30	Lack of inspiration and united prayer	
31	Lack of good research and information on the remaining task	
32	Lack of effective cooperation / coordinated action between mission agencies	
33	No common goals or strategies for world evangelization	
34	Unhealthy churches that are not able to reproduce themselves	
35	Other. Please specify_____	

Question III. 37-47. (Omit Question 36) What do you believe God is calling His people to do in world evangelization over the next 25 years?

Select 3 only & rank from the highest=1, 2=second highest, 3=third highest		1=highest
37	Preach the gospel to every person using personal evangelism	
38	Make the Scriptures and gospel message available in every language for both literate and non-reading by radio, TV, the Jesus Film, Bible translation and distribution and by CD	
39	Do you believe God is calling you to set goals for your ministry?	
40	Seek social transformation—seeking positive change in the whole of human life materially, socially and spiritually, by recovering our true identity as human beings created in the image of God and discovering our true vocation as productive stewards, faithfully caring for our world and people.	
41	For the church to be a prophetic voice to the city	
42	Establish an indigenous church planting movement within every people group on earth	
43	Reach unreached social groups such as the youth	
44	Ethnic Reconciliation	
45	Develop regional and global mission-field partnerships for mission agency cooperation and coordination	
46	Get the church involved in things like: • developing a primary health care network • improving the health of communities • teaching adults, and especially women, to read and write • establishing primary schools for those who have no schools • developing vocational training programs to give skills to young people	

Question IV. 48-59. (Omit Question 47) What would be a suitable phrase (watchword) to capture the essence of world evangelization to serve as a unifying paradigm for the next 25 years?

	Select 3 only & rank from the highest=1, 2=second highest, 3=third highest	**1=highest**
48	The Whole Church taking the Whole Gospel to the Whole World	
49	Fill the World with the Glory of God/ God's Glory for All	
50	The Power, the Presence and the Peace of God for all	
51	City-reaching	
52	Social Transformation/ Transforming our World	
53	Turning the World Right Side Up/ Changing Our World	
54	Christ's Kingdom Come	
55	The Church for Every People	
56	The Evangelization of the World in This Generation	
57	Discipling the nations	
58	Should the watchword have the time frame of 2025?	

Question V. 60-72. (Omit Question 59) How important are the following for Global Evangelical Structures provide to local believers to enhance world evangelization efforts?

	Select 3 only & rank from the highest=1, 2=second highest, 3=third highest	**1=highest**
60	Inspiration and prayer networks	
61	Serve their country/Bless their country/Nation building	
62	Leadership development	
63	Pertinent information for world evangelization	
64	Resource networks linking to resource geographical and/ or functional world evangelization initiatives	
65	Functional networks linking by ministry-type	
66	Reports of what is happening in other cities/countries	
67	Relationship building with other leaders/Fellowship networking opportunities	
68	Place and opportunity for missiological reflection	
69	Geographical networking opportunities	
70	Place for publications on missiological issues	
71	Other. Please specify_____	